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REFRAMING GENIUS

The Genius

of Conversational Reframing

A Module of the NLP Master Practitioner Certification

Written and Designed by
L. Michael Hall, Ph.D.

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L. Michael Hall, Ph.D.
Neuro-Semantics® International
P.O. Box 8
Clifton, CO 81520
(970) 523-7877
meta@acsol.net

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CONTENTS

I: Overview: Framing and Reframing **4**
Executive Summary
Meanings — Frames — Reframes
Lines that Change Minds

II: Preparation for Learning Mind-Lines 14
Getting into the Right State: State Accessing Patterns
Adopting Empowering Beliefs
Attitudes for Super-Charging your Learning
Clearing your Path of Interferences

III: The Conceptual World of Meaning 23
Seven Directions and Best States
Mind-Line Diagrams
How You Make Meaning
The Meta-Move
Prompters

IV: Examples of Reframing 52
Failure
Learning Difficulty
Confrontation
Saying Mean Things
Being Late

V: Reviewing the Art of Reframing 66
Simplifying the Simplifications
Knowing What to do — When
Elegantly Delivering Mind-Lines
Mind-Lining as a Belief Change Pattern

Appendices: 67
A: NLP Presuppositions
B: Meta-Questions for Teasing out Meta-Levels 65
C: Changing Beliefs with Mind-Lines 70
D: Bandler's Mind Changing Lines
When Richard Bandler Played the Blame Game 73
E: Worksheet for Creating Mind-Lines 78

Author **98**
L. Michael Hall

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Meaning governs all of life. Everything you experience— do— feel — is a function of the meanings that you give to things. Given that, are you satisfied with all of your experiences, actions, and feelings?

The greatest difference between people is not their finances, their station in life, their skills, their intelligence, etc. It is their meanings— their frames. The difference in their responses/ reactions are their thoughts, states of mind, and frames. This creates their attitude and determines if it is a winning attitude, an undefeatable resilient attitude or a loser attitude or a victim attitude.

The ultimate fact — Human Reality is a Construct. And if a construct, then it has structure. And if it has structure, then we can identify that structure to discover how it is put together, and how it works. And if we can discover how it works, we can change it for the better. With Mind-Lines you can reconstruct you meanings so that you have a better map by which to navigaae the world's territory. The ultimate goal with the mind-line frames is to make your communication, change work, and unleashing of potentials **conversational.**

A **mind-line** is a sentence or statement that presents an idea, a way of thinking, a meaning that *frames* a subject, activity, or experience and does so in order to create a more effective response. A *mind-line* is *a line* (a statement or question) that influences, communicates to, or even changes a mind. It's a line that carries another way to think about things, another perspective, another frame. A *mind-line* is simply an idea expressed as a question, a statement, a metaphor, or a story that invites a person to try on another way of thinking.

There are *lines* that you use in conversation and writing that when you use it, it has the effect of *altering, influencing,* and even *changing a mind*. It does this because the line succinctly reframes the meaning of something initiating a new and more enhancing perspective or belief. Have you ever heard a line that changed your mind? If you ever hear a great line or story that called into question your perspective and invited you into a new world of meaning, that was a mind-line.

FRAMING AND REFRAMING?

Life is all about frames and framing. Even before you were born, you were framed. You were born into a world of frames—frames set by the people who talk to you, the language they use, the beliefs they operate from, the understandings they have about things, their states, their intentions, and all of the meanings that define who they are and how they live. Given that, what is a **frame:**

> A *frame* is a *frame of reference* by which you understand and interpret things. A frame is an interpretative schema which works as a lense or perception. It is a way to define what things are, how they work, and what they mean. And every time you think of something, you are using and/or setting a frame.

From Framing to Reframing
If you discover that the frames you have absorbed and/or inherited no longer serve you, you can change them. That's called *reframing.* You can develop new beliefs, construct richer meanings, create empowering understandings, decisions, intentions, etc. If you know that you can, learn how to, then you will be free to invent your maps of reality in ways that will serve you and others and empower you to achieve your highest values and visions. This is one purpose of learning Mind-Lines.

Frames of Meaning. The reason you can frame or reframe is that *meaning is a human construct*. We invent it. We invent it via language and symbols. This is the design of the NLP and Neuro-Semantic Models. Your life is neuro-linguistic and neuro-semantic because *the meanings you create (or receive) are the meanings that you live.* What is "meaning?" It is *holding* an idea in mind. *Meaning* —"to hold in mind."

NLP— Neuro-Linguistic Programming began as a model of expert communicators and how they made transformative changes with their clients. NLP identifies how language influences thinking, emotions, and behaviors. It is a model of how three world-class communicators (Perls, Satir, and Erickson) were able to perform incredible transformation in conversations.

> "While the techniques of these wizards are different, they share one thing: they introduce changes in their clients' models which allow their clients more options in their behavior. What we see is that each of these wizards has a map or model for changing their clients' model of the world, i.e. a meta-model which allows them to effectively expand and enrich their clients' model in some way that makes the clients' lives richer and more worth living." (*The Structure of Magic,* 1975, p. 18)

"Magic is hidden
in the language we speak.
The webs that you can tie and untie
are at your command
if only you pay attention
to what you already have (language)
and the structure
of the incantations for growth."

If you want to know—
- What is this "magic" and what is its structure?
- How can you find and use the structure of a magic for unleashing your potentials?
- What happens in the process that strikes us as "magical?"

— this is what this training is designed to reveal.

Living in the House of Language (quotes used in the book, *Mind-Lines*)
Philosophers of language have well known the power about the power of language:

> Wittgenstein: "The limits of my language are the limits of my world." (1922)
> Henry Staten: "Language is what bewitches, but language is what we must remain within in order to cure the bewitchment."
> George Orwell: "Those who control language control people's minds. Sloppy language invites sloppy thought."

George Bernard Shaw: "You see things and you say *Why*; but I dream of things that never were and I say, *Why Not*?"
Rudyard Kipling: "Words are the most powerful drug used by mankind."

Design of this training— learn the art of framing and reframing to use language to empower and enhance lives. To learn how to frame things to create richer and more robust meanings.

Framing as Thinking:
It all begins with framing. You "think" by framing. Everything you think, you frame in some way or other. There is no "thought" without framing, although most framing occurs outside of awareness, as the unconscious structure of your thinking. You also think by creating layers upon layers of other thoughts, ideas, representations, etc. upon your thoughts.

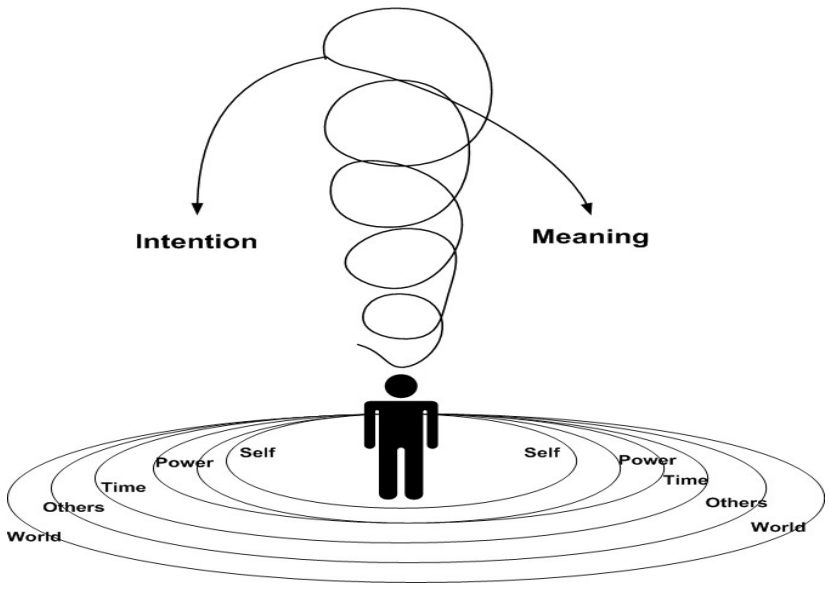
Frames begin as your *references*—the events, people, words, activities, etc. that you are in reference of, then it moves to your *holding* that reference in your mind so that it becomes your *frame of reference.* When this continues, it becomes your *frame of mind*. Knowing this you can explore a matrix of meanings:

- What's your frame of reference?
- What are you referencing as you think about this or that?
- What's your point of reference for making that evaluation or decision?

When you frame and frame your framing, you create a matrix of frames around a given event, subject, or idea. When you do this repeated with all of the events, people, words, concepts of your lives, you create a Matrix. *The Matrix Model,* using development psychology, identifies five content matrices that you construct as belief systems which you then never leave home without.

1) *Representational framing:* You frame your thoughts representationally as you create movies in your mind to present experiences and ideas to yourself.
2) *Cinematic framing:* You frame your representations with various cinematic features. Previously in NLP these have been mis-labeled by the term "sub-modalities." They are actually *meta-modalities.* By them you frame your movies as you edit them.
3) *Linguistic framing:* You frame your movies and their features with words as you linguistically label and classify your understandings of the movies and what they mean to you.
4) *Evaluative framing:* You frame your representations and categories with evaluations as you interpret what the classifications mean to you.
5) *Associative framing:* You frame using your emotions as you associate certain feelings and states to whatever is on your mind.
6) *Perceptual framing:* Your thinking patterns creates yet another frame. Your perceptual filters or thinking style is full of evaluations and emotions and so comprise your meta-program frames.
7) *Metaphorical framing:* You have a level of framing that comes from how you compare things, how you use concrete things to stand for your conceptual understandings.
8) *Intentional framing:* You always have a reason, motive, agenda, or intention in the back of your mind as to why you think, feel, imagine, or do things.

Reframing as Change of Frame:
Once you have a frame, there is the possibility of changing the frame. You can alter the way you have framed things in all of the above ways.



Original Source of Mind-Lines
Mind-Lines originated from the "Sleight of Mouth" patterns that Robert Dilts developed (and later wrote a book about, 1999). In *Mind-Lines,* I intentionally *avoided* that phrase due to the connotations of trickery, manipulation, and fooling someone that the metaphor of "sleight of hand" suggests. I did not want *Mind-Lines* to be about that. Because conversational framing and reframing is not about trickery or deception, I chose to use the term *mind-lines* as a more neutral phrase and to identify its nature— a line of language that influences the mind.

The *Mind-Lines* model emerged while working with Dr. Bob Bodenhamer. Our intent was simply to refine the sleight of mouth patterns. When we found them, they were a mess! Then when we applied *the Meta-States Model* to them, we took the 14 sleight of mouth patterns from their dis-organized state that had no rhyme or reason to them and constructed a structural approach.

I took the two linguistic distinctions of the Meta-Model for identifying the "structure of meaning" of belief structures, and imagined a "magic box" of meaning. From that I then I identified *7 directions* for sending awareness to shift perspective. Now you can learn these conversational patterns *consciously and mindfully.*

From mere Linguistics to Neuro-Linguistics
This is not a study of grammar or linguistics, but *the effect that language has in human neurology.* It is *neuro*-linguistics and *neuro*-semantics—what words and meanings *do* to us in the mind-body-emotion system.

Lines as frames for the minds can change minds. In that, they are non-trivial. *Lines* transform lives because we are a *neuro-linguistic* class of life. Out of our *neurology* (nervous system, brain stem, cerebral cortex, etc.) arise our unique human powers of symbolization and linguistics. We live in language and language constructions because that's how we make sense of the world.

Time to Play with Language, Meaning, Framing

Getting serious in this training will limit your learning. To learn best— *lighten up, have fun, and play with language.* Discover what language does in your body. This is the path to becoming masterful with these patterns. Learn to play with some complaints, criticisms, arguments, and excuses.

Later you will find a list of magical *cues and prompters* that will give you some hands-on tools (linguistic environments) that will help you get started. Then you can easily create mind-lines on the fly. Mind-Lines tell a brain where to go! They directionalize consciousness. And don't you sometimes need to tell your brain where to go?

Do everything you can to stay playful and to avoid getting serious. If you start to get serious and set out to "get it right," and feel a wave of stupidity coming on, stop . . . just in your mind and know even more fully that if you continue to go in that direction, you will get into a loop and it will increase, painfully, until you lighten up and enjoy yourself. The best magicians practice their art in a state of playfulness.

Benefits and Values of Mind-Lines:

- *Become a more professional communicator.* First, distinguish descriptive language from evaluative language. Doing this will give you immense control over your use of language and your effectiveness in communicating. As a result you'll be more persuasive and influential.
- *Handle criticisms, excuses, and complaints elegantly.* You will be able to handle the objections, complaints, excuses, and general non-sense that people use on you (or that you use on yourself) which limit and sabotage effectiveness.
- *Enhance your powers of persuasion.* These patterns will enable you to become more creative and inspirational, more elegant in your expressions.
- *Expand your leadership skills.* You will learn to inspire, be precise, frame, etc. as you lead. With the right mind-line you will be able to touch the minds and hearts of people.
- *Sell your ideas, information, products.* Communicate the value that you add with your products, services, information.
- *Facilitate change.* Enable others to change their minds, habits, emotions, etc.
- *Manage meaning* as you communication more effectively.
- *Cast spells* for yourself and others to make life more fun, productive, and cooperative.
- *Reframe toxic meanings* with new lines. Outframe negative meanings.
- *Set frames in everyday conversations* to effectively handles objections, excuses, and misunderstandings.
- *Create win/win relationships.*
- *Directionalize a human brain* as you send it in one of seven directions.
- *Manage "difficult" customers* as you handle complaints and excuses.

LINES THAT CHANGE MINDS

Have you ever heard a line that changed your mind? How well acquainted are you with the fact that there are in the world *lines* that the mere uttering of them can totally and absolutely *change* a mind? Do you believe that? Do you believe it yet? How surprised would you be to find yourself believing that in the next few minutes and then feeling more motivated than you have ever before, would that be surprising?

Certainly you have heard such *lines* before, have you not? You were minding your own business and then somewhere, somebody uttered some idea, some statement, some belief, or some understanding and suddenly it completely *changed everything* about you and your world.

My Story

I remember one such line. I was minding my own business when . . . well, actually, I wasn't minding my own business, but that's another story. I was teaching Assertiveness Communication Training workshops as a psychotherapist when I came upon a statement about communication. I only had to read it once (well, actually several times; it was a real mind-stunner at first) and it began to work its magic on me. Here is that line:

The meaning of your communication is the response you get—
regardless of your intentions.

Zap! I had always thought that *the meaning* of *my* communication was *the meaning* that **I** had in my head and sent out to others. I said what I meant. A spade was a spade (well, shovel spades are not playing card spades, but that's another story!). If the other person "didn't get it," that was that person's fault. I had been trained well in the John Wayne School of Communication: I shot from the hip and called a spade a spade. Strictly business. No B.S.

Then came that *mind-transforming line* that altered my way of thinking about communication reality. No longer could I fall back on that blame frame-of-reference for communicating. I would forever recognize that *the meaning* of my communication involved *the response* that I elicited in others. *That is precisely* what my talking and gesturing had called forth. If I wanted more of it—I could simply keep doing more. If I wanted the other person to receive a different message—I could use their response as *feedback* and keep altering my responses until I got the response I wanted. That was my initiation into the wild and wonderful world of NLP.

> **What *line or lines* have you heard that have completely changed, altered, and transformed your life?**

You are today *who and how you are,* due to the *lines* that currently run your mind. What did you just say to yourself about that? We all do that. Inside our heads, we language ourselves and others, for good or ill. And we do so all day long simply because it is our nature as symbol using beings, as a semantic class of life. That's why lines can operate so powerfully in our lives—lines can give us new ways of seeing, feeling, hearing, and being.

Want a New Line?
Would you like an entirely new way to talk to yourself? How about a new way to talk to others? Be more modest? Okay, how about just a few new lines for changing your mind about some things and/or for changing the minds of others? Changing the minds of others, did you say?

Yes, this is the persuasion and influence factor within language and framing. This is yet another use for Mind-Lines. In fact, with Mind-Lines you can develop an extensive repertoire for effectively responding to—excuses, complaints, irrational arguments, non-sense, manipulation, objections, etc. So how about it? Would you like to become a perception changer?

MODELING AND THE CONSTRUCT OF MEANING — MIND-LINES
When you model, you are looking for the constructs of meaning within the minds of the exemplars— their understandings, beliefs, decisions, identities, ways of thinking, etc. You are essentially looking for and asking, "What are the frames of mind that enable them to do what they can do?"

The general category of these higher level constructions is the category of *beliefs*— and when it comes to beliefs— there are many different kinds:

- Cause-Effect beliefs
- Significance beliefs (complex equivalence)
- Identity beliefs
- Intentional beliefs
- Supporting beliefs

And on the opposite side, there may be or there may be the resolution of other beliefs:

- Interfering beliefs
- Prohibition beliefs
- Diminishing beliefs

In modeling you will be searching for the required beliefs in the new strategy and those in the old strategy. What are the constructs of meaning that inform and drive the behavior of excellence?

PART II:

PREPARATION FOR LEARNING MIND-LINES

"Why can't I fly, Tinkerbell?"
"To fly, Peter Pan,
you've got to find your happy thoughts."

GETTING INTO THE RIGHT STATE

The Right State for Reframing
Mind-Lines for Eliciting the Right States

Are you in the right state? The best state?

To learn the *Mind-Lines Model* and to have it at ready access, part of our training will involve state management, state development, and access. Due to the nature of *neuro-linguistic states,* when you want to do conversational reframing, the state makes all the difference in the world. In fact, a person could have a mastery level of this model and yet *not* have the ability to use it—at certain times. *State* plays that much of a role.

- What kind of a state do you need to access in order to operate optimally in using this word magic?

Accessing Empowering States:
A mind-body-emotional state is made up of your thoughts and physiology. These are the two royal roads to state:

- **Mind:** thoughts, ideas, representations, beliefs, knowledge, etc. Your internal representations made up of the sensory representational systems that make up your mental movie, words for the sound track and for the frames. These give us a cognitive pathway into the state.

- **Body:** physiology, neurology, state of health, biochemistry, etc. This involves how you stand, sit, move, breath, sleep, etc. Crucial facets of your neuro-linguistic states. Together these comprise your mind-body-emotion system as an interactive system.

Exercise: Accessing A Magician State

1) Get with a Partner.

Identify who will first play experiencer and coach. Who wants to go first?

2) *Elicit a playful state.*

The coach is to induce a playful, mischievous state by using the two induction formulas:

Think about a time when you experienced X . . ..

Imagine what it would be like if you fully and completely were X . . ..

3) *Anchor the state.*

When the experiencer reaches a high level experience of the playful state (a "7" on a scale of 10), nod head or indicate to the coach so that he or she can *anchor* the playful state.

4) *Switch roles.*

Switch roles so that everybody gets into the *right kind of state* to learn, absorb, and play with these Mind-Lines.

EMPOWERING STATES FOR MIND-LINES

What *state* do you need to access and operate from so that you can live and experience these empowering beliefs?

Stage I: Seeking to Understand

1) Know-Nothing

Innocent seeing, perspective. Releasing judgment

2) Curious, Inquisitive

Full of questions, wonders, fascination, interest.

2) Alert, in sensory awareness

Able to be present, in the moment, able to calibrate to what's happening in the present.

Stage II: Creativity in Inventing New Choices

1) Flexibility

Open, changeable, flexible state; not rigid, close, or map/territory confusion, "This **is** that!

2) Playful, Experimental— Creativity

Playful, not serious; bantering and teasing. Fun, joy.

3) Mischievous

Being a bit naughty.

Stage III: Delivery

1) Empathetic

Compassion, care, thoughtful; be nurturing, gentle, kind. Putting the person's benefit first and foremost.

2) Bantering, teasing, ludicrous

3) Challenging, Provoking

Pushing, probing, challenging, putting the brutal facts in one's face. Willing to disturb the person's peace, create discomfort, stretching.

4) Calm and Relaxed

Keeping one's cool and presence of mind in the midst of criticism and pressures.

STATE ACCESSING AND MIND-LINING

Mind-Lines structure involves external trigger setting off internal state that has layers of meaning. Now let's use these variables to create your own mind-lines for state induction. The final line will operate as your self-anchor for getting back in state. It will be an anchor at a higher, meta-level— a conceptual anchor.

The Pattern:

1) Identify a state that you would like to access.

What state would you like?
Why is that state important or valuable to you?
Is that the best state for this exercise?

2) Elicit the external trigger for the state.

What triggers this state for you?
When and where has something evoked this state in you?
What were the triggers?
What were the external behaviors?

3) Elicit the internal state.

What is the state like?
How do you know you have it?
How much do you have it?
What is it like inside? In your muscle tone, breathing, etc.?

4) Elicit the meaning of the trigger, the state, then the meaning of the meaning.

What does this state mean to you?
When you say that it means this, can you say more about that?
When you have that fully, what does that mean?
And what else?
And where does that take you?
What do you believe about that?

5) Turn all of this experience into a single succinct line.

For just a moment be fully with this experience and begin to bring it all together into a single line, a succinct statement that capsulate it.
Test: Does that line now induce you into that state? If so, how fully?

SUPPORTING BELIEFS

- What supporting beliefs, understandings, knowledge base, and values enable us to get into the kind of state optimal for learning and using *Mind-Lines*?
- When Bob and I first explored this question, we modeled each other. Then we modeled others who seemed to quickly, easily, and automatically produce effective *word magic* in the context of objections, "problems," difficulties, etc. This enables us to collect the following list of supporting and empowering beliefs.

1) Every statement or objection has within it an answer.

I know that no matter what objection a person may raise with regard to a project, product, or service that we could offer—deep within the person's objection I will find an answer to it. Every objection carries within it its own solution.

If you believe and using this as an operational directive, it puts you into a place of curiosity, interest, and respect. It empowers you to keep exploring, gathering information, and finding out numerous things about the person's model of the world (the person's drives, motives, values, objectives, interests, understandings, etc.).

2) Every statement and objection is only feedback, never conflict, failure, etc.

This frame informs you to *not* code feedback as failure or personalize it. It is only feedback, only information. Stay emotionally neutral when undesired responses come your way, use it to keep exploring, seeking first to understand, and creatively thinking of other alternatives.

3) I played a part in every response that I get; the communication process did not occur without me contributing something.

Meaning doesn't exist in the external words, signals, gestures, etc. that I produce, but emerges from the mind of a meaning-maker, I never know what I have communicated. And, if I never know what I have communicated, I will therefore constantly elicit more responses, and seek for more feedback, and use such to keep adjusting myself to the person's current reality. This keeps me proactive and vital and keeps me from thinking or feeling like a victim.

4) Personalizing contributes nothing.

Instead of *personalizing*, I recognize that I "am" so much more than all of my thoughts, feelings, speech, and behavior! I will not reduce myself or others via labeling, name-calling, insulting, or contempting because something seems disrespectful.

Giving and receiving information says nothing about my identity or destiny. I will not put my self on the line due to someone else's grumpy state. Sometimes I may have to write down a statement, and play with it for awhile, but eventually I will identify the magic formula within it.

5) I can detect and recognize meaning and frames in human experiences.

I refuse to be overwhelmed by language, words, or objections. Beliefs are just human constructs that I can detect and recognize. Then I can formulate an understanding of the meanings and *play* with it, framing and reframing to my heart's content.

6) I know how meaning works and how we

humans live in conceptual realities.

I know that meaning is an internal job within the mind of a meaning-maker. Recognizing this saves me from the unsanity of confusing map and territory. Just because someone says something does not make it real! I refuse to take offense at any word. At best whatever someone says exists only as a *symbol.*

7) I can jump logical levels in a single bound and faster than my clients or customers!

Meaning not only occurs at the primary level, but also at meta-levels. I can and will work with and negotiate meta-levels. The person with the most flexibility in jumping logical levels will have the most influence.

8) People deserve getting the opportunity to have their maps expanded and will generally appreciate receiving the gift of getting more choices and resourcefulness.

OBJECTIONS THAT STOP YOU
Exercise

1) In a group of 3 or 4 persons, brainstorm about various objections, complaints, statements, and beliefs of others that you would like to have more choices and options in how to respond.

2) Include in your brainstorming, a list of *internal* self-talk lines that put you into not-so-resourceful states with which you would like to have more resourcefulness.

3) Come up with *3 or 4* of the very best lines that you will share with the whole group to use as we play with Mind-Lines.

COMEDY NIGHT IN META-LAND

1) Identify a belief, excuse, complaint, idea, etc. that you want to reframe.

We will make a list of these and each group will be assigned a line or several lines to *mind-line.*

2) As a group, run the belief through the Mind-Line Patterns.

Use the worksheets for this.
Keep expanding your awareness of the structure of the piece of meaning that you're playing with.

3) Refine the lines into One-Line Succinct Statements.

Once you have the lines, then you can endow them with humor. Bathe them in plenty of humor.
Then practice refining them.

4) Deliver as a Stand-Up Comedy Routine.

Attitudes to Super-Charge Your Learning

Make lots of mistakes!

Set your goal to *make lots of mistakes* in using these language patterns because if you start out understanding everything and doing everything right, you have no room for growth or improvement. This is important enough to begin off badly! The more mistakes you make, the more you will learn, the more refined distinctions you'll make. Avoid making yourself into a "have to be right" freak. If you do, you have to wear stupid glasses!

If you don't seem to have a particular aptitude for language, you might find that you'll have to simply practice these skills more often. But just as you learned to speak, these patterns will also become habituated and part of your way of moving through the world—if you give them a chance.

Relax your fears about it being unethical.

While this began as *The Sleight of Mouth patterns* and many have used them to pull the wool over people's eyes, that kind of behavior is not built into the model. Any powerful tool can be misused. Any powerful tool can also be used to make life richer and fuller and more worthwhile—for yourself and others. You can also use it to make a lot of money, to empower people to have more fun, and to access more pleasant and resourceful states. You can use these magical reframing patterns to blow out objections and excuses. You can use them to get your way, win more often, become more persuasive, influence people to see your point. *How* you use these very, very powerful patterns, in fact, is in your corner of responsibility.

Trust the Process.

Trust the process. You may *not* get some the pieces as we move on. Just let that be as you trust that you may just be learning a lot more than you realize and that when we begin tying things together toward the end of the program, you may find the overloading and confusion of lots of data taking new and exciting forms and formats for your own unique style of understanding.

Give yourself to patience and persistent practice of the Mind-Lines.

Learning Mind-Lines is like learning to play the piano. First you have to learn the keys—where they are, what they are called, what sounds they produce. Then you have to go through *the drills*. But eventually... the day comes, when all of the practice, the memorizing, and the repetition pays off. Eventually the day comes when you can play... can really, really play. You can set at the piano and just *let it rip*. You can invent new tunes. You can play by request. You have become an artist.

CLEARING THE PATH

Some states interfere with the ability to learn and use conversational reframing. These limiting states can undermine your skill development and even sabotage your ability to get it. You will want to avoid them or interrupt them if you happen to fall into one of them or reframe them.

For example, if a salesperson gets into a state of fearing rejection, down and depressed about low sales, upset about finances, feeling desperate to make a sale, etc.—these do not describe the kind of states in which he or she can feel playful, flexible, cognitively alert, etc.

What can we do about such?

Why not simply *reframe the meanings that create those states?* Use this model to clear your own path. The Mind-Lines model not only empowers you to work effectively in communication and relationship with other people, it empowers you to work effectively with yourself. After all, the existence of your states, the expressions of those states, and the experience of such all result from the meanings and frames that you created or accepted. When you change those frames (when you reframe your own meanings), you change your perceptions, emotions, and responses.

1) Feeling Overwhelmed

To flexibly play with the mind-lines, you need a good knowledge base about how language works neuro-linguistically. This is what the NLP models (Meta-Model, Meta-Programs, and Meta-States) provides. Aim to learn one distinction at a time! If you demand that you have to get it all immediately, that pressure will undermined your learning. If you focus on both learning and your fear, you divide your focus.

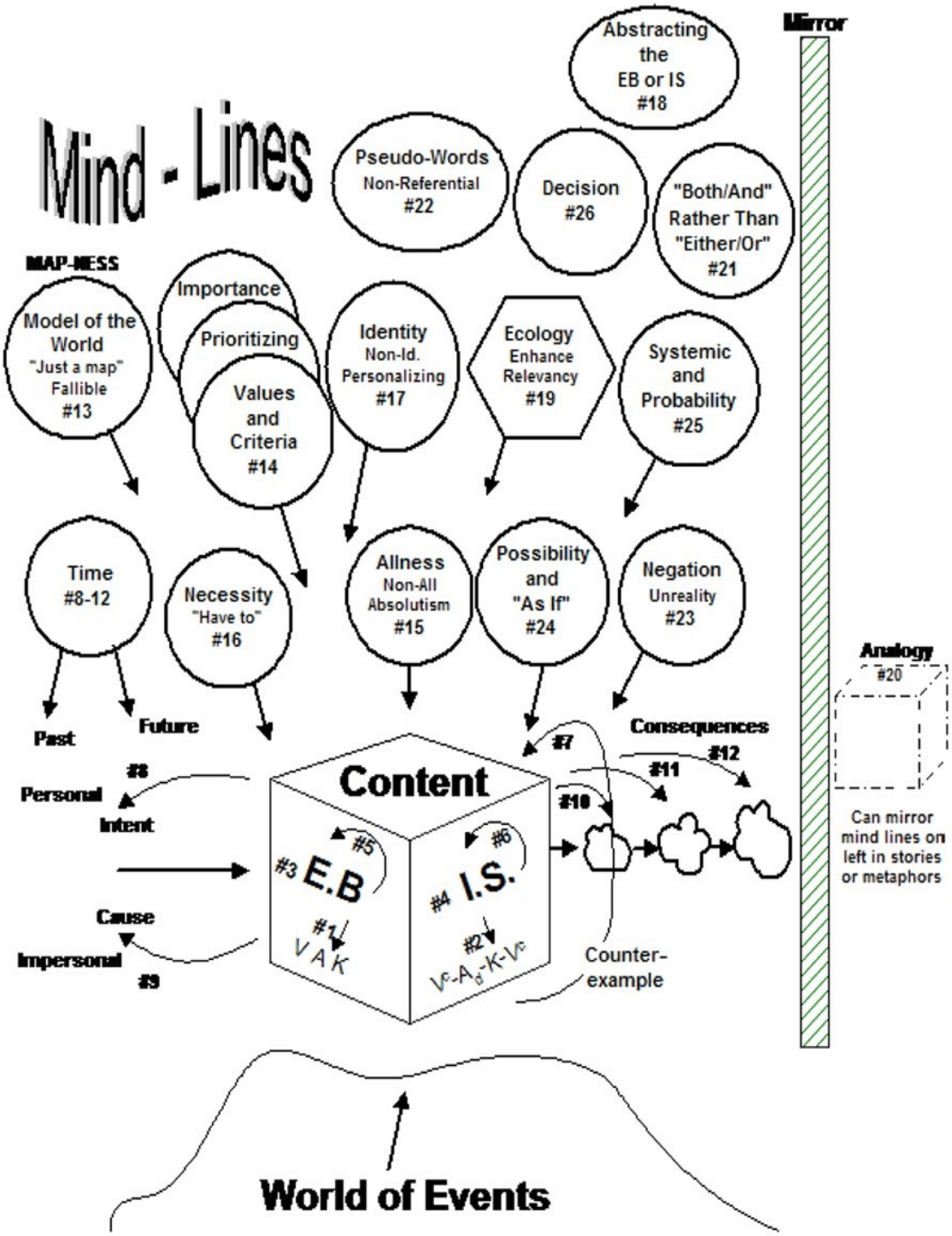
2) Getting too serious about need to get it all and all now!

Lighten up; have fun, enjoy your mistakes, learn from them. Are you serious? What are you so serious about? What demanding-ness are you putting upon yourself? How fast must you learn? How thoroughly on the first attempts?

3) Fear of failure, mistakes, confusion

Does failure, non-achievement, or other conceptual realities stop you? What beliefs cause you to feel bad and limit your effectiveness? As you notice your own internal dialogue as you study Mind-Lines, you will have the rare and unprecedented opportunity to use mind-lines on yourself. Doing this will empower you to get the full benefit from the neuro-linguistic magic that lies at your disposal.

1997/ 1998 Mind-Lines Model

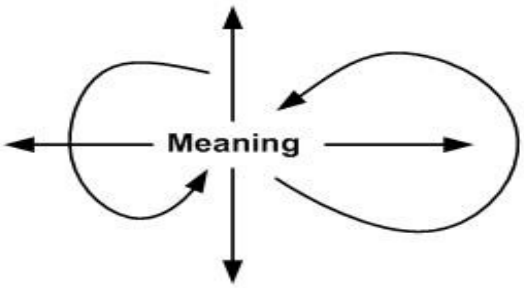


PART III:

SEVEN DIRECTIONS
FOR SENDING A BRAIN

The Seven Directions of Consciousness
As we process information to "make sense" of things and to create the kind of representations so that we can create internal movies of things, we have seven basic directions in which we can move. With this model of *the meaning box* in which we construct our basic associative meanings and around which we construct various contextual frames for higher meanings — you have 7 directions in which to shift meaning. This gives you **7** different ways to *directionalize consciousness* and re-construct new perspectives, meanings, experiences, emotions, and resources.

Down (down to the component elements)
Lateral (back and forth between the variables inside the formula)
Backward (backward in time, for pre-framing)
Forward (forward in time, for post-framing)
Counter (against the formula)
Upward (over the formula)
Analogously (abductively to the side)



This model begins when you distinguish things of *the empirical world* (i.e., the see, hear, feel things) and the things of *the mental or communication world.* If you can't (or don't) make this distinction —you will confuse logical levels. In making such *category errors* will dis-empower you from engaging in the creativity and flexibility of reframing.

As meaning-makers, you *create* meaning. You create meaning *in your minds.* You create meaning in your minds *by connecting* things of the world (sights, sounds, smells, sensations, events, etc.) with *ideas* in your heads. Doing this creates—*the magic box.*

This describes *the heart* of the frame game that we all play. Everyday of our lives, whenever we meet *an Event* on the road of life, we embrace it with *a thought*. We then embrace and fuse that Event with a meaning and, lo and behold, suddenly a *belief* in the

form of an understanding, model, decision, value, etc. arises.

In doing this, you have used your neurology (i.e., brain, nervous system, and all of its conscious and unconscious functions) to *create something new in the world*. You have created a *felt relationship* between a stimulus and your response. In other words, *connect* a thought and feeling to a stimulus—and then, magically, that stimulus "is" or "becomes" that response. At least, it "is" to that particular meaning-maker.

1) Deframing Analysis

Once you have a basic *representation* of something, an idea about something, an understanding, belief, reason, excuse, etc., enter into it to analyze it and understand the component pieces that make it up. This is *de-construction* and requires an analytical frame of mind to detail the components, the elements, and the variables of the experience. Kind of thinking: Analytical, Skeptical.

Ask:

- How do you know that?
- What are you aware of?
- In what sensory representation are you representing that?
- What else is there? How do you know that?
- How do you link X with Y?
- Where did you learn to think and make sense of things in this way?
- What comes first, second, third, etc. that makes up the sequence?

Deframing will either expose the "Magic Formula" or tear it apart. Here you go down or chunk-down *the meaning equation* as you make distinctions about the component pieces of the VAK and language (A_d) that make up the belief format. Chunking down involves deductive thinking and reasoning processes.

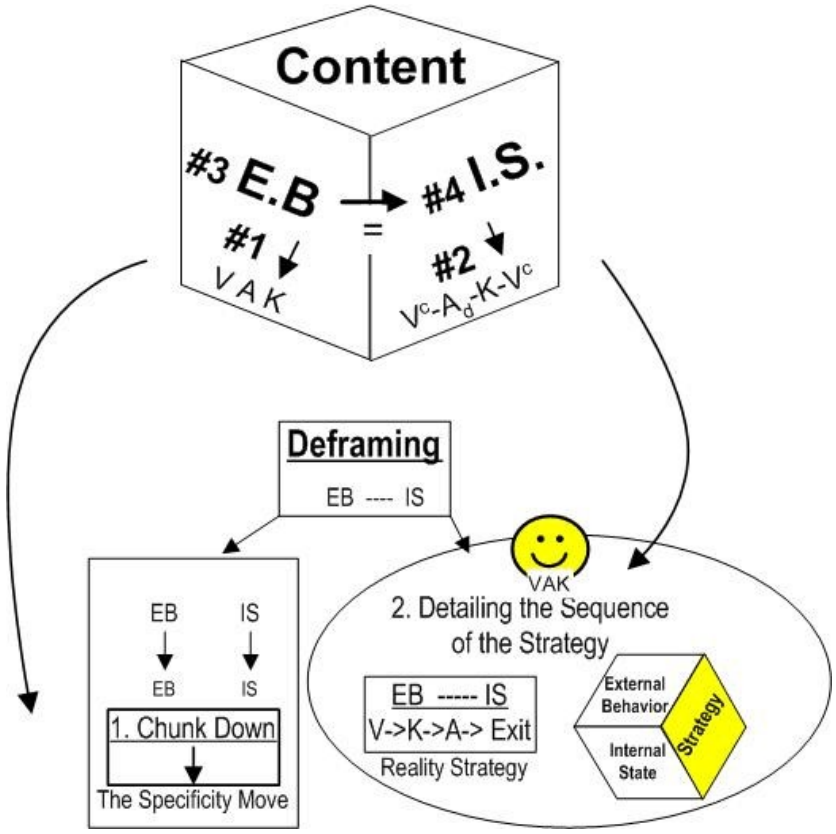
In Deframing you are saying, "Dig down into the formula to find the variables of the belief and how they fit together." This shift helps you to think the thoughts of your belief without needing to believe them. Here you analyze the magic formula and in doing so, it often will evaporate and especially if it
is not a well-formed or accurate understanding. The titles for these two forms of Mind-Lines are:

#1 Chunk Down on EB or IS
#2 Reality Strategy Chunk Down

In unpacking the Mind-Lines model, thoroughly acquaint yourself with the theoretical understandings of the model.

- The formula of the magic box : Cause, Equation.
- Neuro-linguistic formula for conversational reframing
- The Meta-Model

Once you know about the structure of meaning, don't stop with just knowing about the magic formula (EB=IS), go deeper. Go to the structure. Then you will know with precision the specific pieces that make up the magic.



Via deframing you will thoroughly acquaint yourself with *the structure of the magic.* And this gives you the advantage of knowing how the magic works. Practically, this means that if you ever find yourself having difficulties in identifying and clarifying for yourself *the formula* that governs someone's reality, then stop, go back to *Detailing the Magic* and *Getting the Magic Strategy* frames.

Find out how the magic works. Re-discover afresh the very secrets of the magic. Doing this first enables you to specify the pieces within the linguistic structure. It empowers you to demystify the magical formula itself. This works because the chunking down process uncovers the very *structure of the magic*. So by chunking down, or deframing, a person's linguistic and non-linguistic expressions—you thereby pull back the curtains to their subjective "reality." This allows us to see the tricks, the mirrors, and the illusions that support their "black" magic. You can then deal more directly with the Wizard of Oz behind the curtains.

Use *the Chunking Down* process to *specify*. Use the Meta-Model specificity questions to *index* reality:

- Specifically who do you speak of?
- What did they do specifically?
- In what way did that specifically occur?
- Specifically when did that happen?
- And where specifically?

Specifying enables you to *index* the specific referents: who, when, where, how, in what

way, to what degree, which, etc. This corresponds to a similar process used in modern scientific thinking and writing. There you describe the process as *operationalizing your terms*. In other words, you specify in empirical and behavioral terms (in see, hear, feel, smell, and taste terms) precisely what you mean.

In the Mind-Lines model such chunking down accomplishes three things.

1) It gives *the specific E.B.* (External Behavior) of the formula. Doing this enables you to understand what *piece of the world* to which you have reference.

2) It gives *the specific I.S.* (Internal State or Significance) of the formula. In NLP, we consider the *internal movements* (actions or responses) as "behaviors" too (behaviors inside the "black box"). People outside cannot see, hear, or feel these micro-behaviors since they occur at the neurological level of brain and nervous system functioning. Eye accessing cues and sensory-based predicates as well as other signs do provide us some indications of these processes. Chunking down here you may discover that you first made a mental picture in color and close up, then said some words in a sarcastic tonality, and then felt some sensations of tightness in the throat, and then . . .

3) It *sequences* the E.B. and I.S. components so that you discover the person's "strategy" of a particular formula. This puts it all together: first this E.B., then this I.S. of VAK sequencing, which eventually lead to this response. Use the TOTE model format to specify the strategy of the experience.

When you "go down" from the E.B.=I.S. formula to get more specifications—*you simultaneously move up* a meta-level.

How does this *going up* ***and*** *going down* simultaneously work in this way?
Why would you experience a "going up" when you "go down?"

"Going down" into the specific components of an experience *presupposes* that as you *conceptually move down* to identify the specific pieces that you simultaneously move to a higher place (a meta-cognitive position) so that you can *know* and *track* this. You become aware of the smaller pieces, the cinematic features, the distinctions and features within the movie from a meta-position. You do so from a meta-position of *awareness, interest, and understanding* of this process and of what we look for. This put you on the path of discovery of the *"sub*-modalities as the higher logical levels to the modalities and the qualities, distinctions, features and the cinematic features of your movies.

Expanding the Magic Box

With the down-ward move—into the basement level of the E.B.=I.S. Formula, you actually do **not** get *outside* of the Magic Box at all. No, you only go down deeper *inside* it. In this sense, you have only gone deeper within and have *not* moved between logical levels at all.

The Magic Box

E.B. = I.S.

⇓ ⇓

V.A.K. ——> V — A — K — V —> Exit

The unexpected nature of *the detailing* moves in the Mind-Lines model explains its power. You conceptually "chunk down" *from a meta-level of awareness*. This meta-detailing generates more and more enlightenment as you do. You become aware of several things:

- *Your strategy* (the sequence of representations in response to the external stimulus and your own internal components that create the experience).
- *The component pieces* in consciousness that create your experience, your internal coding that generates differences.
- *How* you have created the experience: the formula or mix of pieces that generates the subjective experience.
- And *what* you can do to stop it!

2) Reframing Testing and Challenging:

By first deframing, you pull the components and variables of the formula apart so that you can see what is there, what makes up the formula, how it is represented, etc. This allows you to construct in your own mind a formula of X –> (leads to) Y or X = (equals) Y. When you reformulate the person's mapping and representing in this way, you come to the heart of how he or she as constructed the world of meaning. Now you can begin to test and challenge it to see how robust it is. Kind of thinking: Testing, challenging, possibility.

Ask:

- Are you sure that X leads to, or is, Y?
- What if that X was actually Z or Z^n? What would that mean to you?
- What's the possibility that X is actually Z or Z^n? Would you like it to be that?
- You know, if you really want to see Y (IS), you ought to take a look at J (EB)!
- It is not X, it is Y.

Reframing is the Lateral Pass. Reframing occurs in the center of the chart at the heart of meaning —inside the box of meaning. In terms of the Meta-Model, this is where you will find Complex Equivalence and Cause —>Effect statements. These *meaning equations and attributions* define the heart of your or another person's neuro-semantic reality. Here you shift the meaning associations, "It doesn't mean this, it means this." This is known as *content reframing*. In content

reframing, you say, "Don't think that about this thing, event, act, etc. in that old way (X), think about it in this new way (Y)." The title for these Mind-Lines are:

#3 Reframe EB
#4 Reframe IS

As you specify the sub-modality components as the cinematic features of your representations and the syntax or sequence that comprise *the formula inside the box,* you can now begin content reframing. Formula identification and chunking down thoroughly prepares you to become fully engaged in the magical art of *content* reframing.

Here you most essentially *give new meanings or definitions* to the I.S. and the E.B. Linguistically, you can use the following linguistic environments as cues to get you started:

1) "This isn't this I.S. — it is this I.S."

"This isn't laziness, this shows the ability to really relax!"

"This isn't rudeness, this demonstrates tremendous skill at independence from the opinions of others."

"This isn't insult, this is his bad tonality!"

2) "If you want to see real I.S. — look at this E.B."

"If you want to really see laziness, consider if he wouldn't even dress himself. *That* would be laziness!"

"If you want to see rudeness, consider the insults of ..."

3) "What I really consider I.S. is this E.B."

"What I would really consider as rude is if he picked his nose and flipped it at me. That would be rudeness, not being late."

3) Counter framing for more robust Challenging

By finding the formula of how a person has glued his or her meaning construction together enables you to test and challenge it. To loosen it a bit, to see what it's made of and what other higher frames may be supporting it. Sometimes it will "pop" just by doing this. But mostly you are loosening and discovering. In counter framing, you are testing the *allness* of the belief frame. Kind of thinking: Exceptional, reflexive.

Ask:

- Is that always true? There's never an exception? (Also Allness Framing)
- You can't even think of a time when that's not been true? (Exception)
- Are there no times when that didn't happen?
- If everything stays the same, what would have to happen for it not to happen?
- That happens always for everyone at all times and forever will?
- Isn't what you're saying and doing right now doing that very thing you're complaining of!
- Why X to you too!

Counter-examples looks for exceptions and uses exceptions to shift meaning. Counter-framing works really well when an exception is staring you or the person in the face. Here you move to offer a reframe that *counters the content*. To do that, let your consciousness reflect back onto its own content (the ideas within the meaning box) and apply the meaning equation to the other side of the equation to see if it coheres or if that breaks it up and deframes it.

This reframing directly taps into the mechanism of reflexivity (your self-reflexive consciousness) wherein your mind thinks about its own thoughts. In *Counter Reframing,* you are asking, "What do you think of the belief when you apply it to yourself?" "What do you think of the belief when you apply it to those cases, times, and events, where it does not fit?" The title of these Mind-Lines are:

#5 Reflexively Apply EB to Self/Listener
#6 Reflexively Apply IS to Self/Listener
#7 Counter-Example

To this point you have worked *inside* the Magic Box. You have worked within it by clarifying the formula, moving down to the elements and their sequence that creates *the magic inside the box*. You have worked inside the box to alter the linguistic labels that you have attached to various EB stimuli.

Now the time has come for you to *step aside* from the box entirely. Here you leave *the Magic Box* intact and no longer seek to change it. From this point on you move out of the realm of content reframing and into the realm of *context* reframing. This means that you now will work to outframe the frame. And as you move out into the larger *contexts* within which you reference the magic box—the contexts that you apply to the box sets up new and different contexts. Doing this transforms the meaning of the box—from a higher logical level. Now you outframe.

- Pre-Framing and Post-Framing
- Outframing
- Analogous Reframing

All of the *context reframing* in using conversational reframes involves the meta-stating process. You have stepped *out* of the belief box *and gone meta* to the magic—everything that occurs here involves bringing a meta-level frame (or context) to applying the old formula.

4) Pre-framing for validating and pacing
Now let's go back in time. Where did the idea or belief come from? Why in the world did you or someone else come up with it originally? Often people believe things and *hate* themselves for it. They feel doomed, condemned, or fated to believe the limiting belief. They may even feel guilty for it, ashamed of it, contempt themselves, feel helpless to think anything else, etc. Or, a person may feel invested in a belief, "All of life would be worthless and down the drain if I gave up that belief." This is where pre-framing comes in as a powerful tool. Preframe *a positive frame* about the belief and where it came so that the person can stop beating him or herself up for it and release one's grip on it. This framing is for pacing, validating, and creating rich and deep rapport. Thinking Pattern: empathetic, compasion.
Ask:

- Given all that you've been through, no wonder you came to believe that!
- I can see the value and benefit of why you constructed that understanding, it was because of A and B.
- That makes lots of sense, I'd come up with that way of thinking also if I had been through that!
- Ah yes, now I see why you built that understanding of life. Makes perfect sense!

Framing Time for transformational magic. In these conceptual moves you reframe by mentally moving to the prior or post state to the meaning construction to then "run with the logic" to see if the meaning equation makes sense. Essentially ask, "Does the magic still work?" This reframing move introduces *time reframing* as you play around with the time frame that surrounds the meaning box. Apply various time concepts to the belief.

Pre-Framing says, "Put this thought in the back of your mind and look at it from that perspective." To do this, you will need to put yourself in the other person's perspective (take second position). The titles for the next Mind-Lines are:
Before Time:
#8 Positive Prior Framing (Intention)
#9 Positive Prior Cause

5) Post Frame for provoking
If you really want to disturb, upset, and loosen a belief, provoke the person with it in terms of the consequences that it will lead to. Put those consequences in the person's face and hold their face to it until they face up to it! Post Framing takes *consequential thinking* and uses it to get a person to really evaluate the value of a belief system. It sends the brain out into the future. Thinking Pattern: Consequential, provocative.
Ask:

- What will this idea get you in the next year?
- What consequences will come of it?
- And when you get those consequences, what will that then lead to?

- And what if you live your whole damn life that way, what will that get you?
- You really want to pay all of that price for this idea?

Post-Framing is for challenging. It says, "Take this understanding, belief, or idea and notice how your life will play out as you move into your future. Do you like the consequences that result?" The title of these Mind-Lines are:

After Time:

#10 First Outcome
#11 Outcomes of Outcome
#12 Eternity Framing

6) Outframing for stepping back with higher ideas:

Outframing is a function of meta-stating and involves meta-questions. When you step back from a belief system (*X—> and = Y*) and move up to set some higher frames about it, you can meta-state it with a great many more empowering ideas. This will expand perspective. In this we leave the original belief alone and let some higher perspective touch it and govern it from a higher level. Thinking Pattern: Conceptual thinking.

Ask:

- Where did you get that idea? Does everybody operate from that idea?
- How ecological is it?
- How does it compare with some of your highest values?
- Does it always work?
- Isn't that just an either/or way of thinking?
- What if you looked at it from a both/and perspective?
- Suppose it just vanished away or become untenable for you?
- What is the system of interactions that it operates within? And what is the context that that is within?
- Is that who you are? Are you going to let that define you?
- What have you decided about this?

Meta-Stating or Outframing utilizes the many different kinds of relational interactions that occur when we bring one state to another. In outframing you move to chunk up the meaning construction to higher and higher levels of concept, bringing new and different facets and applying to your neuro-semantic construction. This chunking up moves involve inductive thinking and reasoning processes. Outframing says, "Take this understanding and wrap it around the limiting belief and notice how it changes your perception." Frequently, these moves challenge the limiting belief, multiples it, reduces it, blows it out, transforms it, and many other things. The title of these Mind-Lines are:

#13 Model of the World Framing
#14 Value Framing
#15 Allness Framing
#16 Necessity Framing
#17 Identity Framing
#19 Ecology Framing
#21 Both/And — Either/Or

#22 Pseudo-Words
#23 Negation / Unreality
$24 Possibility / "As if" frame
#25 Systemic / Probability
#26 Decision
#18 All Other Abstractions

The Meta-States model utilizes the principle of *layering* or *embedding*. As you experience thoughts about thoughts, feelings about feelings, ideas about ideas, etc., you *loop back* to some other thought, feeling, or idea and apply it to the previous thought. This *layers* consciousness. It creates an embeddedness—that we typically talk about as "assumptions, presuppositions, beliefs," etc.

Asking "And what idea do you hold *about* this concept?" you get to the frame-of-reference within which the person has embedded the lower idea. Or you could ask, "What do you presuppose *about* this experience?" "What comes to mind when you think about that belief?"

7) Analogous framing for talking about things in a different language:

To think analogously is to think about one thing in terms of another thing. In thinking metaphorically about a limiting belief, step aside and speak about it via a story, analogy, or metaphor. This allows you to be more subtle, indirect, and less confrontative and yet within the story you can use any and all of the other reframing patterns. Thinking Pattern: Metaphorical, narrative.

Ask:

- That reminds me of a story . . .

Shift from inductive and deductive thinking as well as horizontal and counter thinking, and move to analogous thinking (or "abduction," Bateson, 1972). Do this by shifting to storytelling, metaphor, and narrative. In this abducting type of framing, you essentially say, "Forget all of that, and let me tell you a story..." The title of this Mind-Line is:

#20 Metaphoring /
Storying and Restorying Framing

Seven Directions

Knowing that you can send consciousness in *seven basic directions,* and that you have numerous specific patterns within each of those seven directions, you have a whole set of ways to reframe meaning. These seven directions for shifting a mind also describe and illustrate seven types of mental-emotional functioning that set up or construct these dimensions. This means that many Meta-Programs, like many Meta-Model distinctions, fit into the Mind-Line model.

Mind-Lines Formula Summary

1st. Get the Formula.

The first priority is to get the E.B. —> and/or = the I.S.
Keep deframing using meta-model questions until you get the structure of the understanding and belief.
Keep testing to see if you have the formula.

2nd. Summarize the Formula.

Repeat and summarize the formula succinctly to the person's satisfaction.

> "So let me see if I understand you. Where you are coming from is this. When X occurs, you think and feel Y and you do it by Z ... and all of that means A, B. and C to you. Is that accurate?"
> "Have I left any crucial piece out?"

When you mirror the formula back in a summary statement, be sure to be in rapport, matching and mirroring.

3rd. Play within the Box.

Reframe the stimulus and response.
Counter-frame the variables and the formula itself.

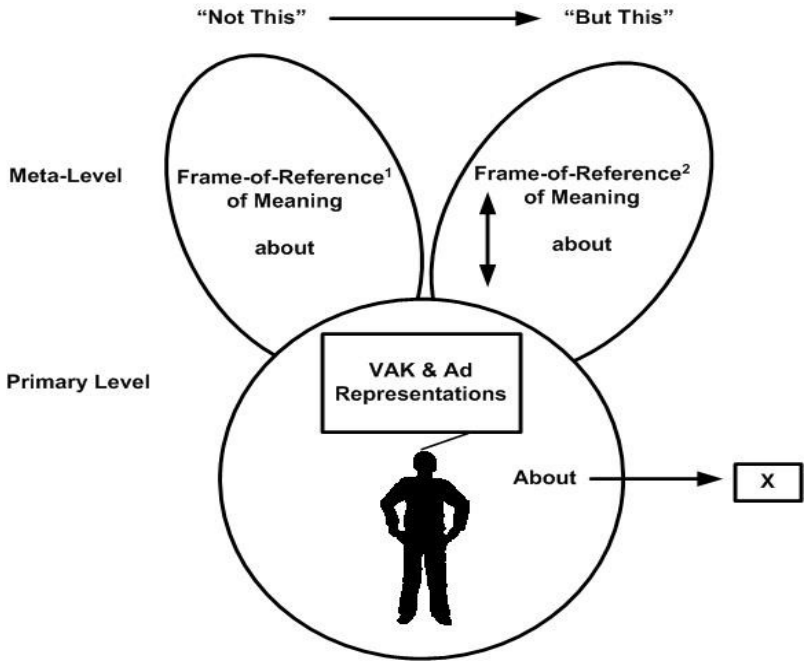
4th. Play the Formula over Time.

Pre-Frame to relieve the person's self-judgment.
Post-Frame to confront the person's self-delusion.

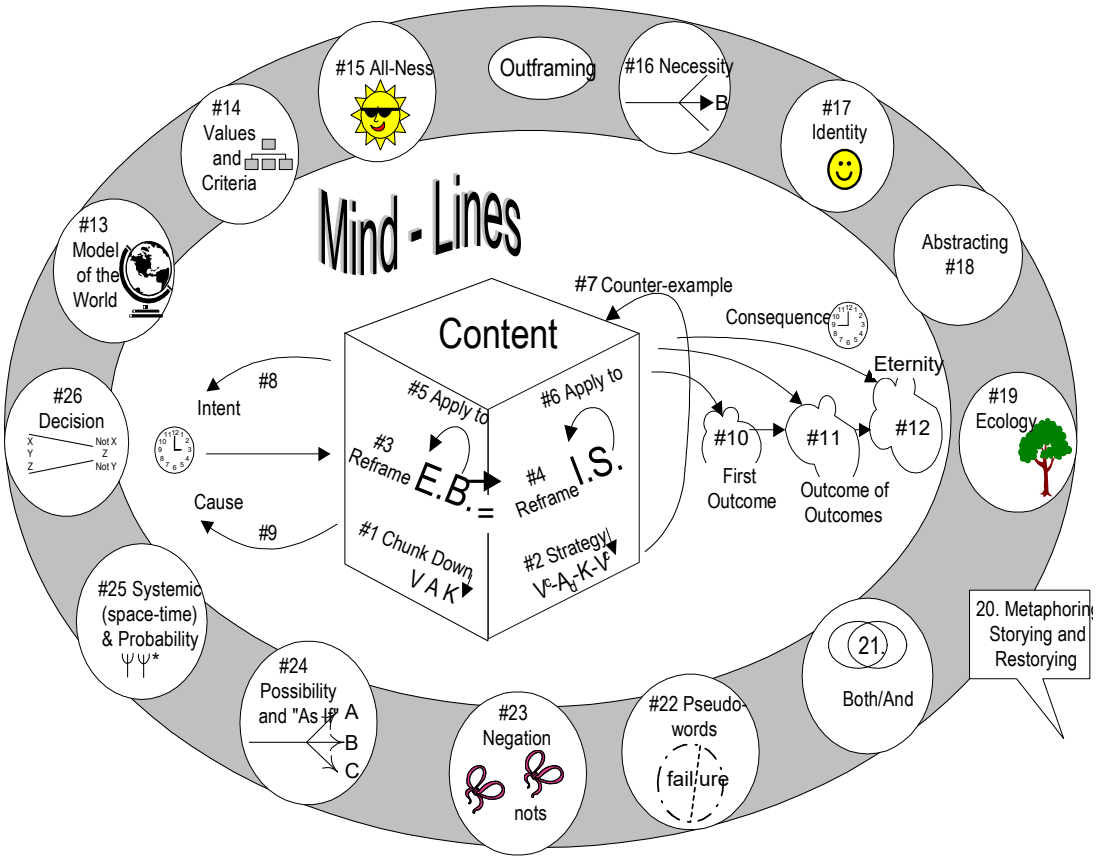
5th. Step back to Out frame the Formula.

Meta-state with all of the resources context reframing.

6th. Step aside to invite a metaphor of the Formula.



Mind-Lines Charts by P.J. Gambardella



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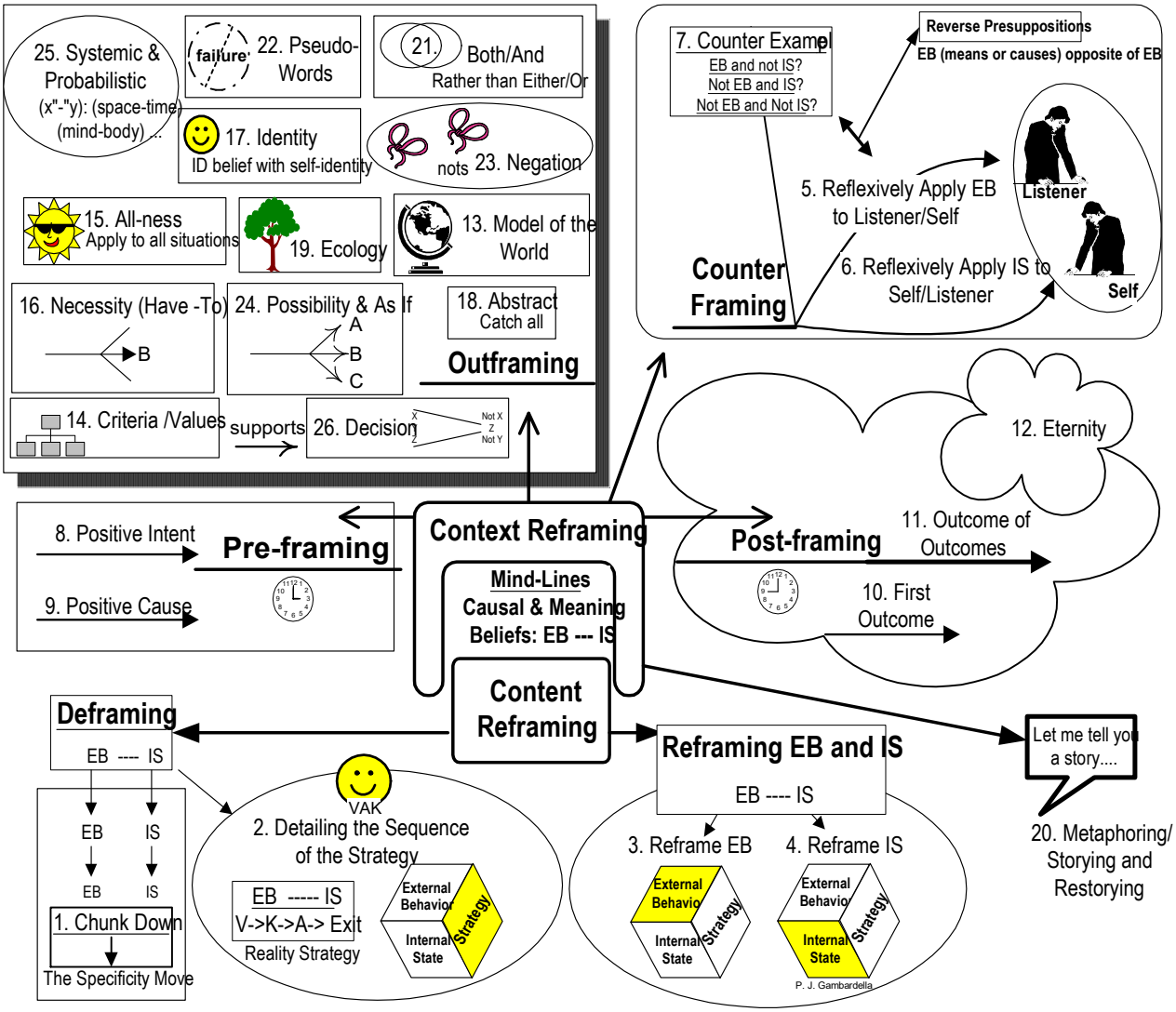


An Insider's Guide to
the Structure of Meaning

HOW YOU MAKE MEANING

U*nderstanding meaning* and meaning-making and how your meaning matrix works is the secret that unlocks tour way into neuro-semantic reality. It enables you to get to *the heart of things.* The following describes *the meaning making process* at the heart of things and details how you, as a semantic class of life, construct meaning in your Meaning Matrix. In this you either *discover* the meanings that others have created and sent our way or we *invent* and *construct* new meanings altogether. Ultimately, meaning is simply made out of the stuff of "thoughts" and "feelings."

1) REPRESENTATIONAL MEANING.

Neither you nor I have ever stumbled over a hunk of meaning on the sidewalk and wondered who left it there. It doesn't exist "out there." *For meaning to exist there has to be a meaning-maker.* And a meaning maker makes meaning *inside.* Meaning is an internal thing; it is an inside job. Meaning does not and cannot exist beyond the human nervous system. It *only* occurs in a mind—as part of our internal mapping of the world. It occurs as the mind *links* one thing with another. If there is no meaning "out there," then meaning is not real, at least not *externally* real. It is a construct of the mind. We make meaning out of the stuff of "thoughts" as we bring an external stimulus in and incorporate it into our inner world.

So you bring the world into yourself by making an internal movie of what's out there. You then use the languages of the mind—visual, auditory, kinesthetic, etc. to generate a movie with a sound-track that you can step in and out of.

As you do this, you thereby create your references and points of reference for your meanings. Now yuou have a frame of meaning. Your *references* are the external events (X) —the events, people, words, activities, etc.—that you encounter. You then represent those events and *hold* those references in your mind. In this way they become your *represented references.* Now they are in your mind. Then what you thing about them becomes your *frame of mind*. Knowing this you can ask and explore— What are you referencing?

S—>R

Stimulus — Response
External Behavior — Internal State

Animals create meaning in this way. The dog sees a piece of meat and moves close to it, smells it, and has a response. His autonomic nervous system *reacts* with a response of salivating which prepares his stomach and organism to eating the meat. All the while, an experimenter *rings a bell.* The first time, the dog doesn't respond to the bell except perhaps to cock his ear. Zero learning has

occurred at this point. But if the meat and bell ringing occurs *together* "at the same time," or in close approximation, the dog **connects** or links the sound of the bell with the meat. Thereafter he responds to the bell with salivating. This is Learning I.

2) CINEMATIC MEANING

You not only create mental movies in your mind, you edit them. After representation there is ongoing development of your inner world of sights, sounds, and sensations. As you step back from your movies, you have all kinds of cinematic features (sub-modalities) that you can use to edit the movie to endow it with various affects. Using the qualities of the visual, auditory, and kinesthetic qualities, you set frames about your movies.

When you exaggerate things in your mind, you either make the pictures bigger or we zoom into them so that is all that you see. This editing of your movie makes the movie bigger or smaller, adds sounds, words, turns up or down the volume, etc. These "sub-modalities" features are actually the cinematic features that you use to edit your movies so you add new and different qualities to your inner movies. Within your cinematic meaning-making is the entire domain of what has been mis-labeled, "sub-modalities." [See *Sub-Modalities Going Meta* (2005) and *MovieMind* (2003).]

3) LINGUISTIC MEANING

The next higher level of meaning occurs when you use language. Language, as a meta-representational system, enables you to do more than just experience movies playing in your mind, with language you can introduce a screenplay and have the movies play to a script. Language also gives us the ability to classify the things happening in the movie so that as you categorize things, you create conceptual meaning from your movies.

Language allows you to put your movies into conceptual boxes. It allows you to *name* things. And it is in the naming of things, calling an event or experience something, that you create more complex levels of meaning. Ultimate your naming calls that reality into being and so it becomes *in your nervous system.* The *language frame* is one of the largest frames that we unconsciously accept and live within, and which therefore governs our experiences.

A mind-line summarizes the encoding of representational, cinematic, and linguistic meanings using the formal language of causation and equivalence. This gives you a structured way to think about the meaning-making process; *it gives you the formula: E.B. > = I.S.*

The first formulation of the Meta-Model[1975, Bandler and Grinder] and the more current development of it Meta-Model[1998, 2001, Hall] uses three linguistic distinctions to formulate this structure of meaning.

- **1) Causation** — the Meta-Model distinction of *Cause —> Effect:* X leads

to Y.

- **2) Equivalence or equation** — the Meta-Model distinction of *Complex Equivalences:* X equals Y.

- **3) Identification** — the Meta-Model distinction: I *am* Y *because of* Y.

E.B. > = I.S.

Linguistically we all create a meaning box. "Saying" and thinking that something *equals* something else *makes it so* in human neurology. This does *not* mean that perception is reality. The Hebrew Proverb puts it succinctly, "As a man thinks in his heart, so he is." Your "reality" is the function of your maps.

"When she looks at me with that expression, I feel discounted."
"When he talks to me in that tone of voice, I know he is angry with me."

In this way, *you actually and literally speak "reality" into being* (i.e. your internal, subjective reality) Once you do, it runs your neurology (e.g. emotions, behaviors, responses).

Suppose you set the frame for a customer, "This is a great deal, but you can only take advantage of it today. The sale goes off tomorrow and this will not be available." If the person buys that frame *and* wants that deal, that frame will determine his or her responses.

These *equations* in language connect things to generate your "meanings." This makes language centrally critical to all of your experiences, skills, abilities, emotions, etc. To change, you have to change these equations. And when you change the equations (the neuro-linguistic equations)—magic happens. Everything becomes transformed. New realities pop into existence.

Meaning is not logical, it is psycho-logical.

The *logic* within your human nervous system is not the kind of formal logical that you learn in school. It is another kind of logic. It is your logic— how *you reason* and connect one thing to another. It is the psycho-logic of your mind that classifies and links things. This *psycho-logic* can even connect irrational things. Once it links things—the brain, nervous system, and all connecting human tissue "knows" at a neurological level that "sassing mom creates devastating effects!" This creates and shows up as your "intuitive" knowledge. It "makers sense" even if it doesn't "make sense."

All of this classifying in various categories makes meaning fluid. Meaning as an internal process connecting inside and outside worlds is so fluid it can easily slip and slide from one meaning to another. As a non-*thing,* meaning is not static or rigid. It keeps moving and shifting. Meaning's *plasticity* means it bends,

stretches, moves, slips, slides, etc. Rather than static, solid, permanent, it comes and goes according to the functioning of consciousness. You *slide* between dimensions of meanings as our images, sounds, representations, and words shift. The fluidity of meanings arises from the nature of symbols. A symbol is arbitrary, it can stand for anything else. This is how you call your felt reality into existence.

When there are ever-shifting classifications meaning keeps shifting.

What does buying a car mean? A customer goes out to buy a new car. But what that "purchase of a new car" *means* to him or her on a given day may change multiple times. It all depends. It depends upon the ideas, memories, referents, values, and thoughts that flow through consciousness. At first it may mean "getting a more reliable source of transportation." But as the person shops, other meanings may flow into the person's stream of consciousness. Now it means, "enjoying looking good in a sharp machine!" And a little later, "a really smart buy—economical, affordable, solid." And then the next minute, "an expression of my power," "an expression of my masculinity," "the envy of my friends," etc.

Coding:
The **E.B.** in the formula stands for "This external behavior that I can see, hear, feel, smell, taste, etc."

The > stands for "leads to" and induces the experience of.

The = stands for an equation, "this equates with that."

The **I.S.** stands for some "internal significance, feeling, state, etc."

Because *meaning* does not (and cannot) exist apart from a *meaning-maker,* meaning bends this way and then that way as you think and feel. This *plasticity* of meaning makes it highly relative so that you can almost allow anything to stand for anything else. Expect the fluidity of "meaning" to keep shifting and changing.

4) ASSOCIATIVE MEANING

Once you have represented and languaged something, you inevitably connect some feeling to it—you associate some emotional state to it. It happens becomes the information of the movie itself is constantly sending signals to your body and your body uses those signals to *feel.*

Suppose you begin with a primary level thought: "This person may reject me." How do you think or feel about that? Do you like it? No? Now you have—

"I hate my thoughts-and-feelings of feeling vulnerable about being rejected by people."

And how do you feel about your *hatred* of your *sensitivity-to-rejection* feelings? You feel guilty about that?

Guilty for feeling *hate/contempt* for *sensitivity to rejection.*

And how do you feel about that? And so on it goes!

Associative meaning arises as you *link* and *associate* one thing with another. By

associating various stimuli with some response, the stimulus leads to your responses. Later it comes to equate with the stimulus so you confuse the two.

This describes the lowest level of meaning construction and the way the higher intelligent animals "think" and give meaning to things. If the name Pavlov rings a bell for you, then you know that it was Pavlov and his work with dogs in his laboratory that launched Behaviorism, Learning Theory, and all of the work on conditioning responses.

> Pavlov works with the natural unconditioned saliva response of dogs. He showed them a piece of meat (or would use meat powder) to activate the dog's responses. When the dogs were seeing, smelling, and tasting the meat, their autonomic nervous system would react by salivating in order to prepare the stomach and organism to eating and digesting the meat. As this happened, he would *ring a bell.* Whether on the first time or the tenth, the dog would begin to unconsciously link bell with meat. Eventually, the bell would trigger the saliva response *as if the dogs were thinking that they could eat the bell.* In this way, what was unconscious and unconditioned could be used to create a conditioned response— salivating to the sound of a bell. And with that, a new inner reality was created, a new stimulus—response pattern.

Through the ability to link or associate an event with an internal response, new *gestalt relationships* between stimulus and response can be created. Often it happens accidently as in this case:

> In one of the big earthquakes that shook southern California in the 1980s—just prior to the quake, a mother became upset with her little 5 year old for slamming a door in the house. Just has she began a new scolding and stating that "something really bad will happen if you keep doing this," the little boy slammed the door and then the whole house shook and trembled, dishes crashed to the floor, lamps came tumbling down, etc. This absolutely terrified the little boy—who *in his nervous system*—connected "slamming the door" with causing an earthquake. He also connected, "arguing with mom" as leading to an earthquake.

At the heart of things — at the Heart of Meaning we have—

1) Things (objects, people)	**What is**	**Nouns**
2) Movement (action, happenings, events**)** **where it came from,** **what's happening to it now,** **where it is going,** **what's happening to it.**	**Verbs**	
3) Description:	**Qualities** **Characteristics**	**Adjectives** **Adverbs**

Associative meaning arises from these linkages and connections because you construct it, it is all invented reality. How does it happen? You create it by taking an **external behavior** (**E.B.**) (like slamming a door, sassing mom) and you link it up to an **internal state or significance (I.S.).** You may think that the external event may lead to a *Cause—>Effect* or you may think of it as equating to (equals) some internal state (a Complex Equivalence in the Meta-Model) (i.e. disaster, pain, horror, etc.).

This summarizes how you, *conceptually and linguistically,* encode your understandings of a stimulus and a response. You encode this as a *formula* that describes *the structure of meaning.* Hence the **E.B.=I.S.** formula at the heart of meaning.

You create embedded layers of meanings in layers of frames. Meaning occurs in frames-of-reference. Meaning emerges from your dynamic layering of thoughts-and-feelings. It comes from your embedded frames. *Meaning always and only exists in some frame,* hence the term *"frame"* and reframing.

"What frame of reference does this or that idea occur within?"
"What frame is this person using to say or perceive this?"
"What frame has to be there in order for this statement to make sense?"

5) EVALUATIVE MEANING.

Evaluative meanings begin to occur as soon as you create your movies. And they also occur as you use language to classify things, as well as when you link up various emotional associations to them. In all of these steps, you are forever and inevitably making evaluations.

- Is this safe or dangerous?
- Should I approach or avoid this?
- Is this good or bad?
- Is this painful or pleasurable?
- Is this valuable or worthless?

To represent any and every experience and event, you have to put it within some frame—some cultural reference, personal frames, family frames, business and economic frames, etc., so *every frame is loaded with evaluations.* This is our glory and agony. It is what makes us meaning-makers and what challenges us to suspend meaning and just witness things objectively.

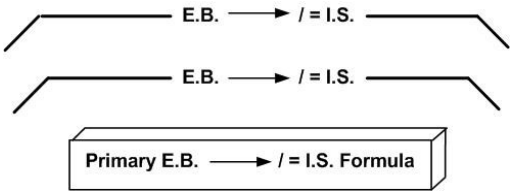
You make evaluations due to the *cultural frames* that you were born in and which are typically outside-of-conscious. To notice your cultural frames, you have to step out of the frame, and the easiest say to do that is to go to a different culture. Then you suddenly begin to become aware of what you had always assumed.

You evaluate because you have no choice about living without a frame. You live in the midst of many frames—frames embedded within frames. The only questions now become—

- Do you know your operational frame?
- Does the frame serve you well?

- Who set the frame?
- Do you want to set a different frame?

Meaning is systemic.



Because meaning occurs simultaneously at multiple levels, this introduces *complexity* into your meaning-making. Once you have your primary level representational meaning of an event, you begin linking it to words, feelings, classifications, concepts, etc. This gives the first E.B. >= I.S. formula. But it doesn't stop there. Then you build up EB=IS formulas *about* your EB=IS formula. Frames never come singularly, they come in bundles, in clusters, in families, in matrices.

> To a salesperson, a "customer" may "mean" "a source of income," if the person has linked the person looking to buy a product as having that significance to him or her. Of course, a "customer" may also mean other things: "someone who may reject me," "someone who I may enjoy getting to know," "an opportunity to practice my skills," etc.

Human minds never stay put. Just as soon as you create a meaning formula, you experience additional thoughts *about* the first one. You think about your thinking. You feel about your feelings. These meta-cognitive responses initiate your multiple-levels of meanings.

This is what we call "reflexivity." Your processing *feeds back* onto itself creating a cybernetic system. Meaning grows from *the associations* you build into *the contexts* or frames that you put around your formula.

Because meanings can be toxic, one evaluation that's essential to make is about the *quality* of your meanings. You need to quality control your meanings and explore what your frames in terms of what they are doing to you and in you. Inside your minds-and-bodies, whatever *meaning* you create becomes *neurologically "real"* to you. It puts you into "state." It governs your neuro-linguistic states of consciousness. It can then modulate both your central and autonomic nervous systems. Though "real" in this sense—the meaning and the frame may not serve you well at all. The meaning may make you sick.

Where you have *a meaning,* you have a frame and a series of frames. No wonder most of your meanings operates at un-conscious levels in the matrix of your mind. You live in them as you live in the atmosphere. They operate as an unnoticed canopy of consciousness in which you live and breath and move.

6) PERCEPTUAL MEANING

With all of the frames within frame structure your meanings eventually "get into your eyes" to become the way you see the world, your perceptual filters. That's what *meta-programs* distinguish. Created from your meta-states, your meta-programs are your lenses through which you see the world, ourselves, each other,

and everything. They are the "programs" in your mind that govern your perceptions. See *Figuring Out People* (1997, 2005).

7) METAPHORICAL MEANING

As all words and language *stand for* something other than themselves, all words and language is metaphorical. None of it is actual or real. There's an *as if-ness* to all of our symbols and symbolic systems. We use a symbol to *stand for* something else. This means that there's an arbitrary nature to all symbols—which also explains the fluidity and plasticity of meaning. You layer levels of metaphor upon your experiences, emotions, mental movies, etc. You can also do this consciously. You can ask, What is this like? How shall you compare it? And from there, you can create layers of metaphorical meanings.

8) INTENTIONAL MEANING.

A part of meaning is intention. When we ask, "What do you mean by that?", we are inquiring and asking about a person's intentions, motives, agendas, drives, etc. Within all of your representations, movies, editing, languaging, evaluating, associating, etc., there are intentions and purposes. This means that all of your frames and meanings are motivated. You are seeking to do something for yourself. Of course, whether your intentions are fully actualized is another question. But that you have good intentions, positive motives is our working premise. By this premise we can call positive intentions into existence.

Yet because all frames are not useful, and because frames that become toxic or unuseful over time, checking out current intentions is a powerful way to make sure your neuro-semantic system is ecological. Run *an ecology check* on your meaning frames to check them out and make sure that you are aligned with your intentions.

- Does this thought, emotion, state, belief, etc. serve me well?
- Will it enhance my life, bring out my best, put me in a resourceful state, and empower me in reaching my goals?
- Will it enable me to act in a way true to my values?
- Or will it limit me, reduce my effectiveness, and put me at odds with my own highest values and beliefs?

There You Have It —

To perform linguistic magic conversationally— to enter into the secrets of magic—you need to know the structure of magic. With these insights about meaning, you have the basic understanding for how the basic mechanism of meaning-making works, which you will use in the Mind-Lines Model.

You can now alter meaning precisely because *meaning exists as a phenomena of two worlds*—Plethora and Creatura. "Meaning" is half physical (E.B.) and half psychical (I.S.). It pops in and out of your life—now materializing, now vanishing. Yet with the technology of reframing, you can now tame this beast, you can transform it.

INSIDER'S SECRETS ABOUT MEANING

1) MEANING IS SLIPPERY.

Meaning slips and slides; it is a shape-shifter.

> *"Why can't I fly, Tinkerbell?"*
> *"To fly, Peter Pan,*
> *you've got to find your happy thoughts."*

As a non-*thing,* meaning is not static or rigid. Instead it keeps moving and shifting. Because meaning has plasticity, it bends, stretches, moves, slips, slides, etc. Rather than static, solid, permanent, it comes and goes according to the functioning of your consciousness. In the TV series *Sliders*, several humans slide between worlds and dimensions. In real life, we slide between worlds and dimensions through the sliding of our meanings.

2) MEANING IS INVENTED.

It's all invented reality because we construct meaning. It takes a *meaning-maker* to create meaning, meaning emerges in our experience as a human construct. We construct or *invent* our internal sense of reality.

3) MEANING HAS A FORMULA.

You take an **external behavior** (**E.B.**) and link it up to an **internal state or significance (I.S.).** This is the formula that generates our meanings, beliefs, understandings."Saying" and thinking that something *equals* something else *makes it so*—at least, it makes it so in human neurology. An old proverb summarizes this idea succinctly, "As a man thinks in his heart, so he is." Your "reality" operates as a function of your maps. You speak "reality" into being. Once you do, it runs your neurology (e.g. emotions, behaviors, responses).

"When she looks at me with that expression, I feel discounted."
"When he talks to me in that tone of voice, I know he is angry with me."

4) MEANING IS EMBEDDED.

We embed meaning in nested frames. Meaning always exists in a frame that is within yet higher frames. What is your frame of reference? What frame are you assuming in your statement? Where you have *a meaning,* you have a frame of reference. An idea, thought, or emotion as a personal *meaning* attains much of its "meaning" from the ideas, experiences, events that it references. *Most meaning operates at un-conscious levels.*

We live in the midst of many frames—frames embedded within frames. So inquire: What frame do you operate from? Does the frame serve you well? Who set the frame? Do you want to set a different frame?

5) FRAMES GOVERN MEANING.

Frames govern, modulate, organize, drive, and control *the experiences* that occur within them (i.e. the thoughts, feelings, language, behavior, and responses). When we set a frame, that frame will govern the consequences and conclusions that follow. Korzybski called this "logical fate."

6) HE WHO SETS THE FRAMES GOVERNS THE EXPERIENCE.

The frame setter rules. That's because all experience in terms of our emotions, higher states, etc. occur in some frame—some cultural reference, personal frames, family frames, business and economic frames, etc.

"He who sets the frame controls the experience" describes what happens in relationships and cultures everywhere. Someone will always set the frame. It works simply and profoundly. If I walked up to you and started talking about your automobile, I thereby *set the frame* for our conversation. Setting the frame refers to setting either *the content* of the subject matter or *the context* for the subject matter. If I ask, "What automobile do you prefer?" I have set *the context* of the conversation as eliciting your preferences (hence values and criteria) while, simultaneously, I have set *the content* as that of discussing particular automobiles.

7) MEANING IS COMPLEX.

Meaning is systemic, has multiplicity, and is therefore *complex.* At the primary level of "meaning," an event is linked to an idea or feeling. This is the EB >= IS formula. Yet we also have EB=IS formulas *linked to and embedded inside of multiple* EB=IS formulas.

The structure of this involves *reflexivity*. The processing *feeds back* into itself so that as a cybernetic system. Meaning operates first from *the associations* and then from *the contexts* (frames) that sets the environment around it.

8) MEANING CAN BE TOXIC.

Meanings can be real and unuseful at the same time. Inside our minds-and-bodies, whatever meaning we create becomes neurologically "real" to us. It puts us into state and governs our neuro-linguistic states so that it modulates both our central and autonomic nervous systems. Though "real" the meaning and the frame may not serve us well at all, but undermine our wellness, effectiveness, and life. Consider the *personalizing frame.*

> "Whatever people say to me and whatever events I experience in the world—they are about me. They reflect on me and determine my value, worth, and adequacy as a human being."

Because all frames are not useful, be sure to always run an ecology check on frames to check them out.

- "Does this thought, emotion, state, belief, etc. serve me well?"
- "Will it enhance my life, bring out my best, put me in a resourceful state, and empower me in reaching my goals?"
- "Will it enable me to act in a way true to my values?"
- "Or will it limit me, reduce my effectiveness, and put me at odds with my own highest values and beliefs?"

There You Have It —

To perform word magic in a conversational way and perform linguistic magic, you need to know the structure and incantations of magic. With these insights about meaning, you now have the basic understanding for how to use the model.

With *the Mind-Lines* model, you can magically alter meaning precisely because *meaning exists as a phenomena of two worlds*—Plethora and Creatura. This half physical and half psychical creature of "meaning" pops in and out of our lives—now materializing, now vanishing. Yet with the technology of reframing, we can now tame this beast, we can transform it. We can, in a word, become a true Dragon Master.

The Seven Directions of Consciousness

With this model of the meaning box wherein we construction our basic associative meanings and around which we construct various contextual frames for higher meanings—we now have 7 Directions for shifting meaning.

Down
Lateral
Backward
Forward
Counter
Upward
Analogously (abductively to the side)

This gives us **7** different ways to *directionalize consciousness* and re-construct new perspectives, meanings, experiences, emotions, and resources.

THE META MOVE

Sometimes you just have to go meta.
The jump to a higher level of thought-and-emotion:

- Whenever you have a *thought* or an *emotion* about another thought-or-emotion, you have just made a meta-move. You have jumped to a higher logical level— a level that now refers to, relates to, and is *about* the lower level.

- Suppose you feel curious and interested in *Mind-Lines*. Then suppose you get *wondering* if your curiosity is strong and intense enough to carry the day. Now you have curiosity-*about*-curiosity. If you *decide* it is not (a thought at yet another higher level), you might elicit a sense of *excitement* about the possibilities and values of learning conversational reframing.

- Meta-States refer to any state of mind, body, or emotion about any other neuro-linguistic state. Fear of your anger, joy about your learning, decisive about committing yourself to your ongoing development, excitement about the ecstasy of love making, etc.

- You jump logical levels and *move upward* (conceptually) because you have *self-reflexive consciousness*. Your mind and emotions can *reflect back onto themselves.* You can think about your thinking, feel about your feelings, comment on your comments.

- Such reflexivity can create enhancing and debilitating *loops* and spirals of consciousness. You can also use them to create empowering frames-of-reference and attractors for self-organizing states.

- Most **Mind-Lines** involves the reflexivity mechanism and process which the *Meta-States* Model explains and details.

THE LAYERS
OF OUR MEANING-MAKING MATRIX

We construct meaning at multiple levels in our mind-body-emotion system. Within our Meaning Matrix we construct many kinds of meanings.

1) *The meaning of representations*
How we represent or code the movie that plays in our mind.

2) *The meaning of our editorial framing*
The cinematic features and qualities we use to encode our movies that NLP mistakenly calls "sub-modalities."

3) *The meaning of linguistics and language*
The words we use as we set frames for our movies, the words we use to classify the categories for our database.

4) *The meaning of evaluation*
The evaluations we make, layer upon layer, framing things in terms of how we evaluate them as our understandings, decisions, expectations, demands, etc.

5) *The meaning of associations*
How we associate by creating emotional links to things and so setting up feeling frames about things.

6) *The meaning of our thinking patterns*
The meta-programs which colors and textures our experiences.

7) *The meaning of metaphor*
The metaphors we use as we think analogously about our ideas, feelings, experiences, choices, etc.

8) *The meaning of our intentions*
The motivations, agendas, and purposes that drive our focus and direction.

9) *The meaning of contexts*
All of the internal references that we set as our frames for how to understand the meaning of things.

MIND-LINE QUESTIONS AND CUES

As a succinct way to summarize how to think about and remember the *Mind-Line statements and questions,* use the following. As you do, they will become more and more automatic. These are *semantic environments and prompters.* After you use them for awhile and begin to customize them to the way you talk, they will become natural.

DEFRAMING—

#1 Specifying the Magic

What component pieces make up this idea?
How do you know to call or label this X?
What lets you know to think, picture, or hear it in this way?
What do you mean by X?

#2 Getting The Magical Strategy

In what order and sequence do these parts occur?
What comes first, then second, etc.?
What lets you know to first see this and then hear that?
When and where do you do this?

CONTENT REFRAMING—

#3 Reframe the E.B. Content

What really is E.B. is . . .
What else would be a case of this E.B.?
If you want to really see a case of this E.B., consider. . .

#4 Reframe the I.S. Content

This isn't I.S.[#1], it is I.S.[#2]
What other I.S. could we just as well attribute to this E.B.?
If you really want to see a case of this I.S., have you considered Y?

COUNTER FRAMING

#5 Reflexively Applying the E.B. (X)

What a X statement!

#6 Reflexively Applying the I.S. (Y)

So you are doing Y to me?

#7 Counter-Exampling

Has there ever been a time when you did **not** do or experience this?
When does this magical formula about yourself or life **not** apply?
So you have **never** experienced the opposite?

PRE-FRAMING

#8 Positive Prior Intention
Personal

You probably did that because of *stated positive intention.*
Weren't you attempting to accomplish the positive purpose of. . . ?
What would you guess the person sought to accomplish of value to him or her?

#9 Positive Prior Cause
Impersonal

You did that because X or Y occurred, did you not?
What else could have caused the idea or behavior outside your control?

POST-FRAMING

#10 First Outcome This belief will lead to you experiencing the consequences of . . .
What will happen if you run with this idea or behavior?

#11 Outcomes of Outcome If you experience that outcome, what will it then lead to?
As you get the first outcome, that will then lead to X,
is that what you want?

#12 Ultimate Outcome Ultimately, this belief will lead to X and Y, how do you like that?
When you look back on your life having experienced
all these consequences, how will you think or feel about it?

OUTFRAMING

#13 Model of the World Who taught you to think or feel this way?
When you think of this as just a mental map,
how does that change things?

#14 Value Outframing What do you find more important than this?
How does X (some other value) affect this?
When you compare this with X (value), what do you think?

#15 Allness Outframing Always? To everyone?
Would you recommend this for everybody?
Has there never been a time when you didn't?

#16 Necessity Outframing What forces you to think this way?
What would happen if you did not?
Do you have to?
What would it be like if you couldn't?
What stops you from doing this other thing?

#17 Identity Outframing What does this say about you as a person?
When you think or do this, how does that effect your identity?
Who would you be if you didn't believe this?

#19 Ecology Outframing Does this serve you well?
Does it enhance your life?
Do any parts of you object to this?

#21 Both / And Framing: To what extent is this absolutely true?
What makes it so either/or in structure?
Is there any ground for a middle position?

#22 Pseudo-Word Framing: Is this word just a noise and no real word?
What are you actually referring to?

#23 Negation Framing: How real is this thing you're talking about?
What if you found it vanishing in your mind?

#24 Possibility / "As if" Framing: What would it be like if this wasn't so?
Of all the likely possibilities, what would you want to happen?

#25 Systemic / Probability Framing: What else plays a significant part in this system?

What are the borders and boundaries of this system?

#26 Decision:

So what have you decided about this?
What would you like to decide?
So is this what you have decided to believe?
Is that what you want?

#18 All Other Outframing Abstractions

When you think about A, B, or C *about* that, how does that influence things?

Relevance
Humor — Teasing
Not apply: it doesn't apply.
Self — Other
Tonal Emphasis
Realization

ANALOGOUS FRAMING

#20 Metaphor Or Story Outframing

Carrying over and applying a referent story
To the Magical Formula Belief

"I have a friend who just last month was telling me about. . .

PART IV:

EXAMPLES OF MIND-LINES

"Failure"
Consider the toxic ideas in this statement:

> *"Whenever I don't succeed, it really bothers me. It makes me feel like a failure. Not reaching my goals is such a bummer. I get depressed. No wonder I put things off and hesitate about other things. I just hate being a failure."*

1) Specificity or "Chunking" Down

So you think you "are" a "failure," do you? As you think about something for which you feel like a failure, and define yourself as such, *how* do you know to do this? If you lost a job once, are you a failure? Twice? Three times? What standard are you using to make this judgment? How do you know to use *that* standard? When, where, and with whom did this occur? How do you represent this generalization of being a "failure?" What pictures, sounds, feelings, and words do you use to create this meaning? If I were to get a sneak peak into the mental theater of your mind—what would I see? How would I know to give it the same name that you have, that is, to call it "failure?" How do you represent the action of failing at one thing as "making" you a failure?

2) Sequencing a Strategy

So up until now, you have accepted the idea of viewing and defining yourself as "a failure." Well, help me understand this. *How specifically* do you know that failing at one thing on a particular day makes you "a failure?" What do you see first, then what do you say about that, and so on as you think about this? If I were someone from the Temporary Job Agency and I could take your place so that you could have a vacation from this, teach me *how to do this the way you do*. What would I have to think, see, hear, feel, etc.?

3) Reframing the External Behavior

This doesn't mean "failure," it means feedback. *Not* reaching some important goals really means that you now have some crucial information about how *not* to get there. So, with that in mind, you could feel more free than ever before to explore new possible avenues.

4) Reframing the Internal State

How interesting that you say that. What I really find as a failure, and I mean Failure with a big **"F"** is someone who does not reach a goal, and then sits down to wallow in whining and refuses to try again. When the person rolls over in the mud and won't learn or try again, I'd call that a "failure."

5) Reflexively Applying To Self

Does that mean if you don't reach your goal in presenting this limiting and painful belief to me, that just talking to me will turn you into an even bigger failure? You have to succeed at this communication or it will mean that and *that* only?

So as you think about not reaching a goal and labeling it as making you a "failure," I take it that you do this a lot? You take a specific instance and over-generalize it into a whole category? And you do this so successfully, don't you? Would you like to fail at this success?

6) Reflexively Applying to a Listener

So with that way of thinking about things, if I don't succeed in coming up with a good way of responding and helping you with this limiting belief, I will also become a failure? In other words, my success or failure as a human being depends on succeeding in this conversation in just the right way? There's no room for experimenting, feedback, or dialogue?

7) Counter-Example Framing

When you think about some of your successes—and how good and resourceful you feel about them, you mean if you mispronounce a word, or fail in any aspect of any goal surrounding that goal, *that* that would turn you into a failure? "Success" is that fragile and "failure" is that solid?

8) Positive Prior Intentional Framing

Reaching the goals that you set for yourself must mean a lot to you. I can imagine that you develop this perspective to protect yourself from messing things up and to push yourself to higher levels. Since you want that, perhaps some other attitudes about failure might help you to really succeed in your goals.

9) Positive Prior Causation Framing

It strikes me that it's important for you to set and reach goals. So you probably have taken on this limiting belief because you have had some painful experiences in the past and you now want to protect yourself against such. Perhaps it was those experiences that actually seduced you into that limiting belief. What other beliefs could you build that you would find even more effective than this one?

10) First Outcome Framing

What results when you move through life defining experiences and yourself as "failures" just because you don't reach a goal in precisely the way you want to? Does this serve you well in setting and reaching goals or in feeling successful? Do you like those negative unresourceful feelings?

11) Outcome of Outcome Framing

Imagine going out, say five or even ten years from now, after you have defined every unsuccessful attempt at reaching a goal as turning you into a "failure," and then living from *that "failure" identity* and feeling unresourceful… what will come out of that? Will you take on many risks? What other outcomes emerge when you feel like a "failure" and take that into your future?

12) Eternity Framing

When I think about this, I wonder what you will think when you look back on this belief about failure when you step over into eternity, and I wonder how you will think and feel about this limiting belief that you used as you moved through life?

13) Model of the World Framing

It really is an interesting way to think about events because it really does overload them with so much meaning! Do you know where you got this way of mapping about "one un-success equaling failing?" Do you know that most people don't use that map to torture themselves?

14) Criteria and Value Framing

When you think about your values of enjoying life, appreciating people, doing your best, experimenting, learning, etc., do you not think of those values as more important than making a "success / failure" judgment about your actions?

15) Allness Framing

So since everybody has failed at something at some time in life, that must make everybody on this planet a "failure," a complete and absolute "failure."

16) Have-To Framing

Do you *have to* frame your attempts at reaching a goal in this way? What would it feel like for you if you did not evaluate events in terms of success or failure? What would happen if you didn't do that? Suppose you got to frame attempts as experiments, feedback, or playing around?

17) Identity Framing

What an interesting belief about your self-identity, it seems totally dependent on your behaviors. Is that right? Do you always *identify* people with their behaviors? Do you really consider that people "are" their behaviors and nothing more than their behaviors?

18) Ecology Framing

How enhancing do you find this belief when learning a new skill, trying a new sport, taking a risk or practicing a new social behavior? Would you recommend this belief as a way for others to succeed with greater ease and positive feelings? Does it empower or limit your endeavors?

19) Other Abstractions Framing

The idea of "failure" really seems like a distressful and painful idea and yet you say that it really doesn't serve to enhance your actions or motivate you, so I'm just wondering if maybe this isn't a faulty map that just needs to *evaporate or vanish from the screen of your mind* because it isn't sufficiently real to be useful, but of course, if you allowed it to just *fade away* so that you focused more on using feedback for success, how would that empower you to get on with things?

20) Metaphoring and Storying Framing

1) So if you brush your hair but do not get every single strand of hair in just the right place, that also makes you a failure?

2) When my daughter Jessica turned nine months, she began the process of learning to walk, but she couldn't walk upon the first attempt—nor upon the first hundred attempts. She constantly fell down. And she would sometimes cry. But most of the time she would just get up and try again. As she did, she learned more and she developed more strength in her legs, and more balance and movement, so that eventually she got the hang of it, and had a lot of fun in the process. And I wonder if this says anything that you can **take and apply to yourself now.**

21) Both/And Framing

It sounds like so much of life is *either success or failure* and that there's hardly anything that you notice in-between. It seems like the boundary between what you call 'success' and 'failure' has hardly any distance so that you can step from one to the other in a moment. How useful would you find it to be able to measure *the degree* of these states? Or, perhaps, even better, to recognize that they can both occur at the same time?

22) Pseudo-Word Framing

So you're using this term 'failure' with a lot of abandon and yet we haven't been able to actually point to any specific reference, either in the world or even in concept. This suggests that it's actually a pseudo-word and that you've been tricked by the linguistic fraud of the label itself. And since it refers to nothing *real* or *tangible*, but only to a mapped construct in your mind, do you really need to use this non-referencing term?

23) Negation Framing

I know this isn't possible, but I'm just wondering what would it be like for you if you couldn't compute the meaning of 'failure.' As you think about 'failure' as a non-existing concept, as an experience you cannot experience, because you always get information and feedback, and discover how not to do something, I'm curious about how much more resourceful that would be.

24) Possibility and "As If" Framing

Since the state and experience of 'failure' has been so unproductive and painful, take a moment to imagine the possibility of living in a world where being a 'failure' could not occur, because you were so focused on always gathering more data about how to refine your actions. . . now just

pretend that you are there fully and completely and as you do, show me the face of that state, and the posture, and the breathing, good. . .

25) Systemic and Probability Framing

What's the probability that when you start this new project that you will totally and absolutely fail at it 100%, like someone who knew nothing at all about it? To what extend do you think you'll fail at it within the first 15 minutes? The first day? What about the first month? What are some of the other factors and contributing influences that could improve your odds at making this successful?

26) Decision Framing

So now that you have entertained several new ideas about this whole realm of succeeding and failing, what have you actually decided serves you best? What frame would empower you to get on with life, bounce with the ups and downs, and forever put yourself in a learning orientation? Have you decided to feed and nurture your mind on that idea? What one thing will you do today to begin this new way of moving through the world?

Lines can change minds. Lines can shift the meaning frames you give to experiences and ideas and can influence you in powerful ways. Lines can persuade you to think about things in ways that truly support your ongoing empowerment.

Reframing "Learning Difficulty"

The Toxic Thought:

"I can't learn these Mind-Lines because they involve too much complexity about the structure of the language patterns."

Formula (the Toxic Magic): "Too much complexity" (EB) *leads to—> or equals* = "I can't learn" (IS)

1) Specifying the Magic

How do you know when to judge something as too "complex?" How do you represent "complex?" How do you know it exists as "complexity" and not just one layer of simple ideas upon another? How does the complexity stop you from learning. Would it stop you altogether?

2) The Magical Strategy

What leads you to first become aware of a complex subject? If you first see or say something to yourself, what do you then do? And what comes after that? How do you cue yourself that something has enough complexity to stop learning?

3) Reframe the EB

How interesting! What I really find as truly complex and difficult to learn are the chaotic "word salad" that a schizophrenic produces… trying to find order and structure in that—now I'd call *that* difficult!

4) Reframe the IS

The problem may seem like that you can't learn these language patterns, but perhaps the real problem lies in how much effort you feel that you will have to expend to learn them. You can learn them, but the learning may not come as quickly and easily as you would like it too."

5) Reflexively Apply To Self

What? I don't understand. Why do you have to make such difficult and complex complaints? I just can't figure out what you really mean by these complicated complaints.

6) Reflexively Apply to Listener

Wow! That seems like a pretty complex analysis of your learning strategy! Where did you learn to think and reason in such a complex way?

7) Counter-Example Framing

So do you mean to tell me that you've never learned anything that once upon a time might have seemed *complex* to you? Somehow, the existence of complexity itself prevents you from learning?

8) Positive Prior Intention Framing

How much awareness do you have that this belief about complexity protects you from failing to learn something new and exciting? And yet it also seems to protect you from taking on a mental challenge.

9) Positive Prior Causation Framing

I wonder if you learned this idea because some teacher so happened to give too much information too quickly?

10) First Outcome Framing

So if you use this belief and let it run your life, next year you will have made no further progress in learning these language patterns. How does that settle for you in terms of your communication and persuasion skills?

11) Outcome of Outcome Framing

As you imagine not learning anything about these mind-lines by next year, and remaining unskilled in them again the following year always letting "complexity" put you off —what outcome will that lack of progress lead to? What will result from getting that result?

12) Ultimate Outcome Framing

When you imagine stepping into eternity as you leave this world, and think about having backed off from learning—and especially from learning things that would improve your communication skills, how much do you think you will have missed out on life, relationships, and effectiveness by letting that Complexity Belief run your life?

13) Model of the World Outframing

How interesting to target learning as dependent upon simplicity and the lack of complexity. Do you know where you got this map? From what experience did you map that difficult or layered subjects somehow prevent you from learning? How does it strike you when you realize that this merely comprises a map and not the territory?

14) Value Framing

When you think about your value of growing and developing as a human being—how much more important does it feel to you when you think of the time and trouble you might need to take to learn a complex subject?

15) Allness Framing

Never? You have never learned something which at one time might have appeared to you as complex? Since everybody has encountered complex information at some time, does that mean that they cannot or should not attempt to learn such? Would you recommend this belief to other people? What would happen if everybody on the planet adopted this belief about complexity and learning?

16) Necessity Framing

What would it feel like if you did not operate from this belief that complexity stops or hinders learning?

17) Identity Framing

As you think about yourself as *a learner*, you certainly can think about some things that you have learned, piece by piece, and have learned so well, that when others look at it, they may conclude that you know some pretty *complex* things. What does that say about you?

18) Outframing with Other Abstractions

How do you know that you should label this or that subject as "complex" and not just the next step in learning? What if you discovered that learning complexity actually involves the same mental processes as learning the foundational principles of a field?

19) Ecology Outframing

As you think about believing that you can't learn complex things, how well does that belief serve you? Does it enhance your life? Does it increase your motivation and drive for learning? Does it increase your resilience? Would you recommend this belief to others?

20) Metaphor or Story Outframing

When I first saw a Hebrew text of the Bible, I thought, 'This is really a complex language. I don't know if I will ever learn this.' Then I began to think about the children born to parents who speak Hebrew and how that they just grow up with that language, and that they learn it with as much ease and effectiveness as children in other language environments learn other languages. Thinking about that made me realize the error in my conclusion about the so-called difficulty of Hebrew. I then realized that Hebrew isn't complex as much as simply different from what I already knew. So as I began at the beginning. I first learned the shape and names of the Hebrew letters. I learned a little bit here and a little bit more there and eventually I gained a level of competency that I could read a page of a text. Yet what previously would have seemed so complex now seemed natural and easy—a piece of cake!

21) Both/And Framing

Could learning these mind-lines be *both* difficult and fun? What if the learning is challenging enough to be tough *and fun*—fun enough to enjoy the toughness?

22) Pseudo-word Framing

What are you referring to by the term "complex?" That learning mind-lines may involve one thought upon another, even layered ideas about the structure of meaning and how to format that structure, is certainly understandable. But "complex?" What if that term itself is most of the problem?

23) Negation Framing

I used to think about learning as difficult. Then I began thinking about it as development, as increasing awareness. And then the idea of "difficult" vanished away and I began viewing learning as an adventure and challenge.

24) Possibility and As If Framing

I know this may sound crazy, but what if it were possible to view learning complex things as fun? Or, even as easy? Now wouldn't that be a different point of view?

25) Systemic and Probability Framing

What's the probability that learning will be difficult? Could there be contributing factors other than the content that makes it difficult?

26) Decision Framing

Is this your decision? Have you decided that you will view learning mind-lines as difficult? Would you like to make a different decision?

Reframing Confrontation

The Toxic Thought:

"I really dread confrontation. It makes me feel anxious and scared. Confrontation never solves anything, it only turns people against each other and it ruins relationships. That's why it is bad."

Formula — the Toxic Magic

"Confrontation" (EB) = "Anxiety, fear" (IS) "Directly saying words" = Conflict, "bad."

1) Specifying the Magic

How do you specifically think about confrontation? How big do you picture yourself in relationship to others? What does the picture of confrontation look like, sound like? How loud do you code the words in a confrontation? What referent experiences do you use?

2) Getting the Magical Strategy

How do you know to feel anxious or scared when you picture a confrontation? Why not curious and excited to discover the differences as you fully listen to another's viewpoint and then work out a win/win arrangement?

3) Reframe the EB

If you think conflict or confrontation ruins relationship, try avoidance. Then, one day something will occur that will come as "the last straw" so that one of the person's can't take anymore, then, "out of the blue" that one event will seemingly ruin the relationship.

4) Reframe the IS

Yes, speaking up and expressing your ideas can feel scary, but what really evokes anxiety for me involves **not** speaking up or surfacing concerns while small and manageable, but letting problems fester until they become large and unmanageable!

5) Reflexively Apply To Self

I feel so very anxious right now, and fearful, as you say those words. Bringing this up will destroy our relationship!

6) Reflexively Apply to Listener

So if I bring up anything to you, you have to feel anxious and scared, and think it will ruin things between us? This means you would prefer that I walk on egg-shells in your presence and not relate to you in an authentic or real way?

7) Counter-Example Framing

Thank you for this confrontation—I really appreciate this. I will use this disclosure of yours to relate to you with sensitivity about how things could go awry or hurt your feelings. Just think what might have happened if you hadn't confronted me about this!

8) Positive Prior Intention Framing

In learning to feel anxiety and fear, you probably use those feelings to come across to people in a more gentle way. I just wonder what other ways you have also found, or could find, that would further allow you to incorporate gentleness into your confrontations? So your feelings of fear and anxiety makes you hold back from harsh criticism when things violate your values, I wonder if this concern for avoiding hurt also causes you to develop other effective conflict avoidances?

9) Positive Prior Causation

I can see that the directness of your dad's words and his style made "confrontation" seem

unloving because he did it with too much bluntness and didn't balance it with enough tenderness.

10) First Outcome Framing

When you think about how you have walked on tip-toes over egg-shells with lots of people, and never expressed your values and perceptions—how do you like the consequences that result from that?

11) Outcome of Outcome Framing

When you think about the way people may take advantage of your non-confrontational style and use of intimidation to get their way because they know you won't speak up for yourself—how do you like the consequences that may result from that consequence?

12) Ultimate Outcome Framing

When you look back on your life and see how you couldn't speak up for yourself and how you backed off from every conflict and disagreement because of your belief about confrontation, and you see how you over-cared about what people thought of you—how celebrative will you feel about that legacy or about not having lived with self-integrity?

13) Model of the World Outframing

Who taught you to think about confrontation in this way? Do you think you should adopt this belief as your model of the world? Do you know anyone else who has a different perspective that seems to enable them to produce more productive responses?

14) Value Outframing

You obviously value peacemaking and harmony—yet I wonder how honesty, true self-disclosure, and in-depth communication with loved ones play with, and into, your value of conflict avoidance?

15 Allness Outframing

Suppose everybody thought and felt anxiety and fear in bringing up things to others… would you recommend this style of communication? Would you think it would make the world go better?

16) Necessity Outframing

What would it feel like if you did not believe that you had to equate confrontation with negative encounters? What would you have to think to view it in terms of playfulness, lightness, curiosity, and resourcefulness?

17) Identity Outframing

As you think of yourself as a person with thoughts, feelings, and opinions, and as someone who can express yourself honestly —suppose you imagined the You who did that with dignity, grace, and effectiveness?

18) Outframing with Other Abstractions

How interesting that you view confrontation in this manner—do you also view *communication* in a similar way? What about *honest expression of one's viewpoint?*

19) Ecology Outframing

How well does this belief serve you? How well does it make your life function to equate confrontation with negative relational consequences? How well does it enhance your life for honest communication with those that you love?

20) Metaphor or Story Outframing

Having just started to work there, I really didn't know all the ins-and-outs of the business. That became evident the day that I started to load the truck. I had observed the others loading so I

assumed that I knew how to do it. I jumped in the big truck and backed it up to the dock. Then I began the loading. Just then Jim came running up yelling… I couldn't tell what he was saying, but at first I felt humiliated that he would talk to me that way! Who did he think he was anyway? As he got closer I heard him yell, "Get the emergency brakes set! Jump back into the truck—the truck won't hold by itself!" As I looked at the truck, I saw it beginning to move… slowly, ever so slowly… but moving. After I had the emergency brakes pulled I realized that if Jim hadn't yelled when he did, the truck would have rolled through the glass window at the bottom of the hill and through a daycare. Thank God he had the courage to yell at me when he did!

21) Both /And Framing

do you need to frame confrontation as bad and destructive to relationships? Could it sometimes do that when two people don't manage their states and operate from a win/win perspective?

22) Pseudo-Word Framing

Could "confrontation" be a pseudo-word with lots of semantically negatively loaded ideas when the real idea is just being straight with each other?

23) Negation Framing

Remember when you brought up your views and ideas about the new product and expressed your views about the marketing and how that made a difference in the company? And when you remember that, how much does the fear of confrontation just evaporate as you think of it as just expressing a genuine concern?

24) Possibility and As If Framing

What if you let confrontation be kind and thoughtful directness? If that were possible, if you could confront with kindness and dignity, would you want that?

25) Systemic and Probability Framing

So that's all there is to confrontation— being nasty or obnoxious to others? What if we let other contributing resources texture it for elegance?

26) Decision Framing

Have you decided to treat confrontation as a great evil or dread? Is that your choice? I hope you won't decide to let some possible discomfort put you off. Will you do that?

Reframing Saying “Mean Things”

Statement: *"Saying mean things makes you a bad person."*

1) "Saying what ‘mean’ things specifically? What makes a thing said ‘mean?’ What specifically do you mean by this term 'mean'? How does the mere saying of words to convey ideas and symbols correlate with the negative emotional state that we refer to as 'meanness'?"

2) "When you think about that belief, how do you represent that in your mind? Do you see, hear, or feel it?" "How would you know if it was not true? What, for you, would falsify this understanding?" "What would you specifically see, hear or feel that would indicate when that has occurred?" “Does this start with a feeling and then you draw this conclusion? Or do you first hear the tonality, and then experience a body sensation?”

3) "Actually I'm not uttering *mean* things, rather I'm attempting to express some of the truths and understandings that I have. This isn't mean talk, but expressive and assertive talk."

4) "Bad, huh? If you want to know what really makes a person a bad person, think about the kind of things Hitler did! Executing people makes you a bad person!"

5) "Mercy! That's really a mean thing to say to me!"

6) "Only a bad person could say a mean thing like that!"

7) "So you've never said a mean thing to anybody in your life without having that statement turn you into a bad person?"
"So when you said X to me last week, that made you a really bad person?"

8) "I appreciate you saying that because I know that you're trying to help me avoid relating to you in mean ways. I'm wondering what other ways could you use to insure this goal?"

9) "If hatefulness or ugliness caused me to say those things you consider mean, then I would agree with you and immediately change. But I cut you short because I had a terrible day at work, feel unresourceful, and just didn't think about your feelings as I usually do, and as I want to."

10) "In the long run that belief will prevent people from speaking the truth to one another. How acceptable do you find that consequence for yourself and your relationships?"

11) "Since, in the long run that belief will prevent people from speaking the truth to one another, this idea of moralizing on how people express themselves verbally will lead to argument? And if we keep moralizing in this way, won't that make us more and more judgmental and harmful to each other?"

12) "It may seem mean to you now, but when you come to the end of your life and look back on how our relationship developed to the point where we could truly handle the storms that life threw at us and we didn't have to walk on egg-shells with each other, don't you think you'll appreciate the feedback, especially if, in the long run, it helped you to become effective over such verbal static?"

13) "Where did you learn to think and judge statements in terms of 'meanness'?" "Does that belief about meanness come from your model of the world or someone else's? No? Who created that rule? At what time did they come up with this idea?”

14) "Which matters to you more: how someone speaks or what they actually do?" "Do you think it more important to have honest feedback from others rather than mere patronizing or incongruent feedback?"

15) "Since everyone has at sometime said something mean, the only kind of people that we have on the planet are bad people!" "How enhancing do you think this idea about 'mean words creating bad people' serves the human race? Would this encourage honesty, authenticity, genuineness, and the like?"

16) "What would happen if a person could say a mean thing without becoming a bad person?" "How does a person have to suddenly turn into a bad person because they utter some words that another person might consider mean?"

17) "Ah, so whatever kind of language comes out of my mouth, that makes me, or transforms, me into a certain kind of person? So if I now say a nice thing, I suddenly become a nice person? If I say something about physics, that makes me a physicist?"

18) "So the way I talk to you totally and completely determines my moral character? Does the character of one statement always have this kind of effect on one's identity and being?" [Abstracting using Identity, #17, and Morality.]

19) "You really seem to believe that, but I wonder if viewing the world in that way really makes communicating and relating to others go better or whether it invites you to think of people in good and bad terms depending on how you evaluate their communications in terms of meanness or niceness?"

20)

Reframing Being Late = Not Caring

"Your being late means you don't care about me."

1) "How specifically does my being late carry all of that meaning—that I don't care about you? How late do I have to arrive for it to mean this—30 seconds, 1 minute, 5 minutes, 1 hour? How many minutes late suddenly translates into the meaning that I don't care about you? How do you know that at twelve minutes I care, but that at thirteen I don't?"
"So, if I arrived late by nine and a half minutes, then you will know that I still care about you?"

2) "How do you know that my being late means I don't care? What do you have to do in your head to get these thoughts and feelings going that I don't care about you when you look at the clock and notice my lateness? Do you make a picture of it, do you say words, what words, with what tonality, in what order, etc.? If you said, 'I wonder if this means he doesn't care?' and asked it in a questioning way, what would that do? How would you know when my lateness really means I care?"

3) "My being late doesn't mean I don't care about you. It means I had a lot of things to do at the office, that's all." "It doesn't mean that I don't care; it actually means I care about the quality time we have together and I wanted to get that done and over with so that I could focus on being with you."

4) "My being late only means I had a lot to do at the office. If I really didn't care for you I would not call or come home at all or give you the finger when I pass by! But I took the time to finish the stuff at the office today so that I could spend the day with you tomorrow."

5) "So I can also take it that any and every time you run late for an appointment with me it really means that you don't care about me?"

6) "It seems a little late to tell me, don't you think?"

7) "Have you ever been late and still cared?"
"Isn't it possible for a person to arrive late and still care? Isn't it possible to be uncaring and punctual?"
"My son showed up thirty-minutes late for dinner last night and I know that he loves us deeply."

8) "I can understand how you say that my being late means I don't care. Apparently you really do want to know that I truly care for you, don't you?"
"In saying this you're probably trying to get me to be more punctual since that seems so important to you, and I can appreciate that as I wonder if making an accusation like this really gets people to become more prompt."

9) "I wonder what events in your past has led you to create that idea bout lateness and being cared for?"

10) "When you keep telling me that my being late means I don't care about you, but don't listen to how I do care about you, I feel frustrated and put off and wonder if we should even stay together. Is that the response you want from me—to back off from you or break off our relationship?"

11) "When I think about the effect of that statement, it seems to undermine your feelings of being loved by me and to call into question the validity of my love. And I wonder what will happen

eventually if you feel less and less loved and I feel my love more and more invalidated? It doesn't seem to really build anything solid between us, does it?"

12) "This seems really important and big now, doesn't it? I wonder when you get to the end of your life and look back on this experience--and take in the overall meaning of your life and our relationship—what will this experience mean in the light of that?"

13) "I'm wondering where you got this way of viewing 'arriving on time.' Did you mom or dad equate time promptness with love? Would you recommend this perception to your children so that your promptness or lack of it should govern how they read your love for them or not?"

14) "Actually, arriving late, while important, doesn't seem nearly as important as respecting you and our relationship and planning to spend quality time with you when we do get together."

15) "So I show up late once, and that means I don't care at all about you?"
"Since everybody arrives late at some time or another in their life, then the only kind of people on the planet are those who don't care about anybody?"

16) "Does it always and only work this way? What would you see or hear or feel if you realized that I could care very much and very deeply for you and also sometimes show up late?"

17) "So how I handle time and schedules turns me into a caring or an uncaring person? So truly caring people have got time-management down to an art? Truly caring people always use Day Timers!"

18) "Certainly I can agree that my general and typical behavior towards you says something about how I feel towards you. But how have you decided that one or several actions have this level of global meaning that I don't care about you?"

19) "What an interesting idea. . . but then again, has this idea ever caused you to argue with people, especially loved ones, about time and schedules so that you spent your time with them arguing, rather than enjoying their presence?"

20)

PART V:

SIMPLIFYING THE SIMPLIFICATIONS

Having sorted out the word magic within the *Mind-Lines Model* to create 7 directions to send a brain, and having illustrated this in the Mind-Lines Charts, now I have a confession to make. Mind-Lines Model actually has only *two* levels and *two* kinds of reframing. We have *a primary level* (content) and *meta-levels (*context) reframing.

1st Level: Inside —Content Reframing

This means that #1, 2, 3, and 4 refer to the mind-lines *inside* the box. These refer to the content reframing that more specifically addresses the details of the EB and the IS.

2nd Level: Outside —Context Reframing

This means that *all* of the other *mind-lines* actually occur as *a meta-stating* of the belief statement with some other idea or concept. In all of these, we set a higher frame on the belief frame and thereby outframe it with considerations to other concepts:

reflexivity or apply to self (#5, 6),
reverse of reflexivity or *not*-apply to self (#7),
time (#8, 9, 10, 11 and 12),
the abstraction process itself (#18),
the modeling process (#13),
values and criteria (#14),
allness (#15),
modal operators (#16),
identity and identification (#17),
abstracting (#18),
ecology (#19),
metaphor (#20)
the thinking pattern of both/and (#21)
pseudo-word (#22)
negation (#23)
possibility (#24)
systemic (#25)
decision (#26)

Of course, these mind-lines do not exhaustively identified every conversational reframing pattern available.

Beyond the Box

First-level "meanings" (or primary state meanings) occur *inside* the box. Meanings at this level arise via the formulas and equations that you create neuro-linguistically as you move through life. Thereafter we have second-level "meanings" (meta-state meanings or higher level meanings). These meanings occur *outside* and *above* the box. We refer

to shifting the first meanings as *content reframing.*

"Outside of the box" refers to all of *the contexts* in which we use the formula or equation—and to the various contexts and contexts-of-contexts that you can put around the box—which thereby tempers and qualifies the stuff inside the box.

What we have called "the box" is a concept, a conceptual understanding, meaning, or association. This neuro-cognitive process governs how you think, perceive, feel, and respond. Therefore, if it exists and operates as a piece of *conceptual work* when we put it inside of another conceptual framework or box we have a concept of a concept.

Here one Magic Box is embedded inside of another. By this maneuver you can generate *magic-of-magic,* or multiplied magic. In linguistics this shows up as language-about-language, ideas-about-ideas, reflexivity so that you can refer to other references. In neuro-linguistic experience, it shows up as states, and then states-about-states (or meta-states).

Principles for directionalizing of consciousness in building new maps for navigating life
From *inside* and from *outside* of the magical conceptual box or cube by which we construct and formulate meanings, you can now flexibly maneuver consciousness in 7 directions, thereby giving you many ways to magically reframe meanings.

In summary: Meaning-making and the art of transforming meaning.

- He *who sets the frame* (frame of reference) *governs* (or controls) *the resultant experience* (i.e. emotions, thoughts, and responses).

- *Someone (or some idea) always sets a frame.* You can't escape from frames, beliefs, presuppositions, paradigms, etc. Someone will set the frame of the conversation. You can detect frames and choose your frame, you can set frames you desires.

- *Awareness of the meaning process* (i.e., the meaning placed on a particular belief, statement, objection, etc.) *gives you control over it.* Understanding the structure of Mind-Lines will enable you to maintain awareness of the meaning of objections, questions, perceptions, communication, etc. from the customer. By having and understanding this meaning, you can more effectively manage the flow of the conversation.

- *Language has "magical" like effects in your life.* Mind-Lines can, at times, work like magic for altering your sense of reality and transforming your Matrix of frames.

HOW TO DO WHAT — WHEN

When it comes to the lines that frame things, there is content and there is application. By now you know ***what*** to do in framing and reframing which transforms meaning. But do you know ***when*** to do it with the right person? We now come to a series of questions about the ***how***:

When should you or could you use a *mind-line* with someone?
With whom do you present it and under what circumstances?
Which mind-line format and direction do you use?
How do you decide *which* one to use with whom?

1) First, run a diagnosis of the situation that you want to influence

When you offer someone a mind-line (a sentence that frames things), you are playing around with that person's meaning attributions. You are either aiming to offer a person the possibility of another perspective, expand the person's mind, or to change a mind. Doing this means you are entering into the realm of that person's neuro-linguistic reality and so it is best to run a diagnosis of that reality:

- Do you have permission to do this?
- Does the relationship bear this kind of interaction?
- Do you need to seek permission first?
- What results or consequences might you have to deal with if you offer the mind-line covertly?
- Would you want someone to lay a mind-line on you if your roles were reversed?
- Do you have permission within your own self to *facilitate* such a *change* in another human being?
- Do you have the skill to do it with grace and elegance?

2) Establish a clear sense of the relational context that you are in — With whom?

With whom do you want to challenge, question, extend, expand, deframe, or enhance their attributed meanings about something? The person or persons with whom you want to offer a mind-line establishes *a context* for you. As you identify the relationship you have with this other person, then you can begin to address the following questions.

- Do you have sufficient rapport and trust with this person?
- How do you know?
- Presenting or delivering a mind-line involves leading, have you paced sufficiently to now lead?
- Have you proven yourself trustworthy, open, and respectful enough with this other person? (If you haven't, then the *mind-line* will tend to come across and be felt by the other as manipulative.)

3) Choose the right mind-line.

Assuming that you have the skill, ability, knowledge, internal permission, rapport, trust, and respect with someone (including yourself) to present *the gift* of a meaning transforming mind-line to touch that person with some of your neuro-linguistic magic—which one should you go for? How can you figure that out? Easy, use *the directions of consciousness* format as your theoretical basis. Ask yourself such things:

- In what direction would I want to send this person's consciousness?
- In what direction does this person want his or her consciousness sent?

- What default program describes how and where this person now sends his or her brain?
- Does the belief first need to be deframed?
- Would a straightforward *content reframing* work best with this person?
- What *conceptual frames* would most usefully *outframe* this person and give him or her a whole new and more resourceful frame-of-reference?
- If I use this particular *mind-line* pattern, what kind of response can I expect from this person?
- What meta-program may be a driving meta-program in the person?

The general principle: *Take the person where the person seldom goes.* Next, determine the person's *frames* and *meta-frames.* What directions has the person already sent his or her brain? What frames currently create problems or limitations for him or her? Has the person over-used one particular frame or direction? How has this created difficulties or limitations? In choosing the right mind-line to use, explore the direction and frame which would counter-act the person's problematic frames.

- Does the person need the current frame deframed?
- Does he need his current belief counter-exampled?

4) Calibrate to the current moment— to *now.* What effect will today's circumstances play?
Another governing influence involves *today's events and circumstances. When* you seek to use your magic wand can make a lot of difference. This leads to asking some of the following.

- Is *now* a good time to do this?
- What is the person's current state?
- What things is the person dealing with that might significantly effect what you are offering?

5) Checking ecology so you frame in a balanced way.
It never hurts, before and after delivering a mind-line frame, to run an ecology check on the frame. How has this particular reframing pattern affected this person? Similarly, it never hurts to continually check out your own frames. Doing so enables you to take into account your frames so that you do not project them onto others.

6) Use the present state/ desired state algorithm.
The most basic algorithm involves a frame-of-reference that considers the gap between present state and desired state. Dilts (1990) invented the SCORE model to incorporate this.

Symptoms and **C**auses summarize the current undesired present state description—the problem space.
Outcome and **E**ffects of the outcome summarize the desired future state—the solution space.
Resources specifies the processes needed in order to bridge the gap.

7) Reckoning with the nature of "problems"
Robert Dilts formatted the nature of "problems" from several points-of-view that offers some profound insights with regard to knowing *when* to do *what.* [See chapter eleven in *Sourcebook of Magic* (1998).]

Simple—Complex

Sometimes the difficulty that you seek to address involves a *simple* **S**timulus —>**R**esponse structure rather than a *complex* response having several or multiple layers.

A phobia involves a simple *anchored* response; this X leads to that Y.

Low self-esteem, conversely, involves some complexity. It depends not only upon *what* associations have gotten connected to *what* stimulus, but also the meaning, belief, value, etc. frames that the person puts this concept into.

If you create a disorientation, you shake up a system thereby giving it a chance to loosen up as it moves to restore equilibrium. This may reveal a leverage point of a simple S—>R pattern. If it is in Quadrant III, a complex problem, chunk it down to a more simple S->R format.

Stable—Unstable

Another set of distinctions is Stable— Unstable. How permeable or impermeable do you find the problem? If impermeable, then we will need to first deframe it with some maneuver. Does the difficulty come and go unpredictably. Does it oscillate so it is now here and now gone? If so, then make the instability stable. Stabilize the problem, or some part of it, so you can work with it as you move it to Quadrant I. A stable problem means that you can count on and work with. You can predict it, anticipate it, and set your watch by it. If it is stable, disrupt it— de-stabilize it.

8) Practice your magic.

In late 1997, Disney Studios put out a new version of *Cinderella*. I loved the scene where the fairy god-mother started doing some of her magic. She created the carriage out of a pumpkin, horses from mice, made a beautiful gown out of rags, and other wonder-filled transformations. Upon doing all of this, totally awestruck Cinderella just had to ask, "How did you do that?" To this the fairy god-mother replied, *"I practice my magic."* May you find yourself playfully practicing your magic day by day.

Complex

III. — S—>R — – S—>R – S—>R	IV. Chaos
I. S—>R Phobia	II. Manic– Depressive (E/O)

Simple **Stable** **Unstable**

ELEGANTLY DELIVERING MIND-LINES

You now know how to create neuro-linguistic magic. You now know how to alter the very structure of meaning. You now know how to reframe meaning in a multitude of ways so as to offer new and more enhancing mental maps. Now you're ready to speak the words and call the new worlds into being.

Preparation —

1) What would you like to reframe in your work? (As a coach, trainer, consultant, etc.)
2) In what context: when, where, with whom? Set the context.
3) What frame do you want to set? Make it short, succinct, memorable.
4) What frame will you be speaking to and expanding or reframing?
5) Make your frame as semantically loaded as possible.

DELIVERING MIND-LINES

1) Make your delivery as congruent as possible.

Depending on the nature, quality, and direction of the ML, you will want to make sure that your delivery fits it. Sometimes this will involve a *voice of empathy and compassion*, sometimes a voice of *provocation and aversion*, *questioning and curiosity, wonderment and amazement, conviction,* etc.

Adopt the voice of belief, conviction, and matter-of-fact-ness. Say the mind-line in a way that "just makes sense" so that it has a just-makes-sense tonality. Anchor this *"Of course, it makes sense"* state so that the person feels that the mind-line is meaningful and significant.

2) Pace, pace, pace, and keep pacing until you get rapport before attempting to lead.

If you're going to use the *pacing and leading* format, then use everything you know in NLP to match, fit, and pace —verbally and non-verbally. Keep testing and checking for rapport and then lead out with the mind-line. Give plenty of confirmations and affirmations.

3) Deliver mind-lines from the person / behavior distinction.

Recognizing that *person* and *behavior* occur on different levels, in different dimensions enables you to have the optimal impact for your mind-lines. Since *nothing out there inherently means anything*, how you frame a piece of behavior lies totally and entirely at your disposal. What does this mean? It means that in mind-lining you are not *playing games* or *distorting* "the truth," or anything of the kind. You are framing and reframing so as to create a useful and enhancing map so you all can create better experiences.

4) Use spatial and gestural anchoring in your delivery.

As you mind-line, notice *what* and *how* you handle the spatial territory around you and the other. Because we all externalize our internal maps. We do so with our *concept* of "time," we also do so around other concepts—values, beliefs, convictions, levels, etc. Then bring your gesturing into conscious awareness to support what you are saying.

5) *Semantically pack your mind-line frames.*

Now that you know about a multitude of Mind-Lines, you can become truly powerful and elegant as a neuro-linguistic and neuro-semantic magician by combining and embedding multiple mind-lines into a single statement.

Practice combining 3 to 7 Mind-Lines into a single statement.

> "I really appreciate your concern for not hurting my feelings (#8) as you *have not* brought up this subject because you have viewed it as 'criticism' instead of just being forthright (#4), since just saying words directly as you calibrate to my state (#1) has typically, in your past, meant something hurtful, although you have at times done so with good results (#7), so I guess as you continue to discover that honesty and being authentic (#14) play as important a role in our interactions, that it will serve you much better than walking around on egg-shells with my feelings (#19, #20), or other negative consequences (#10).

To take your persuasion to the next level, *semantically pack* your statements with emotionally compelling terms, images, and suggestions. A semantically packed term has "juice" in it—it *seduces* you to powerfully represent things in such a way that it *lures* you into the state.

> Search for such terms . . . as you in your *explorations* of this *wild and wonderful territory* knowing that you'll get *a lot of mileage* from such terms and be able to *influence* with greater *power and elegance* than ever before.

MIND-LINES
FOR BELIEF CHANGING AND ENHANCING

You can use the mind-line questions to *change* a belief. You can also use them to *enhance and enrich* a belief. I realized that some years ago when doing a Mind-Lines Training in Nottingham England. *Frank Daniels,* the NLP Trainer who sponsored the training, asked me about "taking the Mind-Line questions and intentionally using them to build up, extend, and expand an already powerful and wonderful belief." I knew that was a marvelous idea so I tried it out and sure enough— it works!

Mind-Lining Empowering Beliefs Exercise
Pair off with a partner

1) Experiencer: The person who gets to go first to experiment with seeing how the mind-lines can enrich a belief.
2) Explorer: The person who facilitates the person through the mind-line questions to just explore — and not do change work or an intervention.

The Pattern
1) Identify a positive and enhancing belief that if you believe even more fully, it would truly enrich your life and empower you.

Think about some belief that truly serves you very well which you wouldn't mind enriching, extending, and making even more magical. Express this belief in a congruent and expressive way that you find compelling.
OR: Think of a belief that you find limiting and problematic that you would like to change.

2) Express the belief in a clear and succinct sentence.

Record the statement.

3) Facilitate the process by asking the Mind-Line Question about the belief.

Use the mind-line question from deframing to reframing then pre- and post- framing to outframing. Try to stay in that order. But also be ready to dance around depending on where the person goes. As you do, use lots of *confirmations* and *affirmations* in the process. This keeps rapport with the person. While there is no one right procedure for asking the questions, it is best to use the above procedure as much as possible. The experiencer should simply respond naturally and easily to the quest ions, fully experiencing and being with the representations and feelings of the belief.

The Mind-Line Questions—

What do you believe that is a good belief, even a strong one, but it could be stronger?
Deframe: What do you mean by that EB (external behavior)? What are you noticing?
What does that IS (internal state) mean to you? What are you aware of? First, second, etc.?
What do you call this EB or IS? What else?
What does this belief mean to you overall?
Convincer: How do you know that you believe this? And how do you know that?
So this means this X to you? (Reaffirmation and Confirmation)
Reframe: Could it be that the EB is not really that IS, but another? Maybe....
Counter: When you apply this belief to yourself, how is that? [If the belief is about others.]
Pos. Intent: What was your positive intention in believing this?
Pos. Cause: What were some of the factors that led to you believing this?
Value: How does this benefit you? How does it enrich your life?

How is that valuable to you? And how does this serve in a positive way for you?
Model of World: Did you create this map yourself or did you learn it from someone else?
When did you first learn to think this way?
Consequence: What does this lead to?
And when you get those benefits, what does that tend to lead to?
Identity: When you think this way and use this belief as you move through life, how does it affect your identity or the way you define yourself?
Necessity: Do you have to do it this way?
Allness: Do you always think and believe this way about that?
Ecological: Is it ecological? When you step back from it, is it productive, healthy, and useful?
Metaphor: What is it like?
Resources: What other resource would you like to bring to this belief? (Joy, calmness, etc.)
Possibility: What is now possible given this belief? What else?
Decision: Have you made a decision that you will definitely believe this?

Appendix A
The NLP Presuppositions

Consider following NLP Presuppositions as lines that change minds.

1. The map is not the territory, it is a map made up of symbols *about* the territory.
2. People respond to the world according to their internal maps.
3. Meaning is context dependent, it depends on the context within context.
4. Mind-body inevitably and inescapably affect each other since they are part of the same system.
5. Skills arise and develop as we develop and sequence our representation systems into strategies.

6. We enhance our communications by respecting and pacing each person's model of the world.
7. Person and behavior are different phenomena. We *are* more than our behavior, we are *not* merely our behaviors.
8. Every behavior has utility and usefulness in some context.
9. We evaluate behavior and change in terms of context and ecology.
10. We cannot *not* communicate.

11. The *way* we present our communication affects perception and reception.
12. The meaning of communication lies in the response we get, regardless of our intentions.
13. There is no failure, only feedback.
14. All behaviors and communications occur in the mind-body-emotion system and so are affected by mind, body, emotion, etc.
15. The person with the most flexibility of behavior will have more options and choices in that system.

16. Resistance generally indicates the lack of rapport.
17. People have the internal resources they need to succeed, they only need access and development of them.
18. People make the best choices open to them when they act.
19. People work perfectly well and are not broken.
20. It's never too late to have a happy childhood.

Neuro-Semantic Presuppositions and Premises:

1. If you get serious, you'll get stupid.
2. We can only run our own brains once we take response-ability for our personal powers.
3. We can do so much more together than apart or alone.
4. Personal congruency is our personal and community power.
5. Energy goes where attention goes as directed by intention.

6. I never leave home without my state; I'm always in a state.
7. I never leave home without meaning, intention, my self, and the other facets of my Matrix.
8. Meaning is an inside job; it takes a meaning maker to create meaning.
9. Above and beyond our movies are all the higher levels of the mind that govern the system.
10. Whoever sets the frame governs the game and someone is always setting the frame.

11. Where there's a frame, there's a game; where there's a game, there's a frame.
12. We are not logical, we are psycho-logical.
13. My response-ability *for* myself ends at my nose where my response-ability *to* others begins.

Appendix B

Meta-Questions for Teasing Out Meta-Structures

Of all states, *our meta-states are our most important states.* Do you know why this is so and the reason for it? Precisely because meta-states, as *higher* states, govern, modify, modulate, control, drive, and organize our everyday primary states. In other words, because meta-messages modify lower-level messages (Gregory Bateson, 1972).

The *fluid levels* of meta-states are ever in flux, ever moving, changing, and in process. They are not things, they are not rigid, as mental and emotional energy expressions of representing and framing they arise and vanish according to our thinking and re-thinking. That's why they are so fluid and plastic.

Each of the following terms, by which we describe the logical levels of our mind. If you bring a state of confidence to your self, this operates as a *belief*, and because you treat this as important, you *value* it; you *understand* facets of some *knowledge* of that area which leads to *expectations, decisions*, *identifications, intentions,* etc. Each term simultaneously has within it all of the other terms so that each level can be viewed from a multitude of perspectives or facets. That's why we call the "logical levels" a *diamond of consciousness*—each offers a multi-facetic perspective.

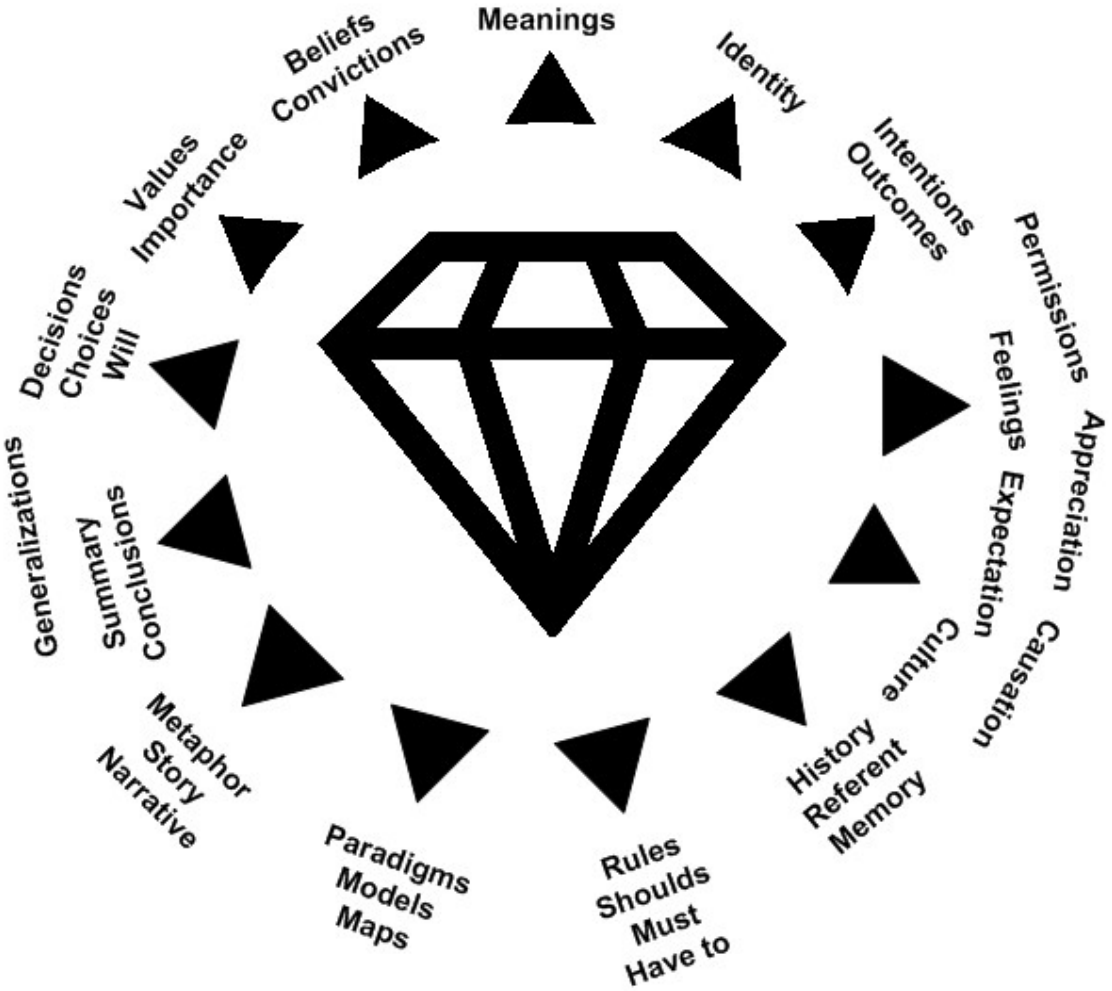
Think of the following as more than 80 ways to move around the *diamond of consciousness* and see, hear, feel and explore the many *facets* of perception and focus. These *facets of focus* give us multiple ways into the Matrix of our mind. So if you use one word or term and it doesn't elicit more information, use another. When we coach to the matrix, we use many questions in each of these categories.

The basic 15 Meta-Questions:

1. Meaning / Significance Ideas that we hold in mind.	What does this mean to you? What meanings are you holding in mind?
2. Belief / Believe / Confirm as real Ideas we affirm, validate, and confirm.	What do you believe about this? What do you believe about that belief?
3. Frame / Reference Ideas we set as our frame of reference and mental contexts.	What is your frame of mind about this? What's your frame of reference for this? How are you framing this experience?
4. *Permission / Allow / Permit / Embrace / Approve* Ideas about allowance and permission versus ideas about prohibitions and taboos.	Do you have permission to experience this? Who took permission away from you? Are you ready to allow this for yourself?
5. Prohibition / Taboo / Censor / Dis-allow Ideas we do not allow and permit but prohibit and taboo.	Is this experience or idea prohibited in you? Would it enhance your experience to taboo this? Who has tabooed this for you?
6. Feeling (any feeling: love, hate, care, joy, etc.) Emotional ideas and feeling judgments we bring to other ideas.	What do you feel about this? What if you could enjoy this? What feeling would enhance this most?
7. Thought / Notion / Idea / Word Ideas or thoughts that we bring to some	What do you think about this? What thoughts come to mind regarding this?

previous idea or thought.	What's your notion about this?
8. Appreciate / Appreciation / Celebrate Ideas of appreciation or value used to frame other ideas.	What do you appreciate most about this? What could you appreciate about this? Do you appreciate this too much?
9. Value / Importance / Count / Honor Ideas we value and treat as important or significant, which we esteem.	What do you value about this? What's important about this that you can count? Do you honor this in yourself or others?
10. Decision / Choice / Will / Pros and Cons Ideas we "cut off" (cision) from other ideas as choices we say *Yes* and *No* to.	What's your decision about this? What choice would you like to make about this? What pros and cons are you weighing?
11. Intention / Want / Desire Ideas about motives, intentions, desire, and wants.	What's your highest intention about this? What do you want and really desire about this? What intention is driving your response?
12. Outcome / Goal / Agenda/ Hidden Agenda Ideas we have about goals, outcomes, and desired ends.	What outcome do you have about this? What goal do you have beyond this goal? What's your higher agenda behind this?
13. Expectation / Anticipation Ideas we have about what we anticipate will happen	What's your expectation about this? What do you anticipate will happen about this? What do you expect about this idea?
14. Rules / Demand / Should / Must / Shall / Authorize / Injunctions / Policy Ideas we use as rules for the games we play in our lives, modal operators that generate our *modus operandi* (MO).	What *should* you do about this? What do you *have to* do regarding this? Why? What is the rule that's governing your thoughts? Who or what authorizes this policy for you? What injunctions are you acting out?
15. *Definition / Class / Categorize / Category Define / Label* Ideas we have that set the categories in our mind for understanding things.	What definition do you use in relating to this? What class do you put this into? How do you categorize this? What other definition could you use for this?

FACETS OF THE MIND



Appendix C
Published in *NLP News* and in *Rapport*

CHANGING BELIEFS WITH MIND-LINES

L. Michael Hall, Ph.D.

In NLP we have several ways to *change* beliefs. The best in my opinion is Robert Dilts' *Museum of Old Beliefs* pattern.[1] The worst, in my opinion, is the so-called "sub-modality" method, the *Sub-Modality Belief Change* pattern. When Bob Bodenhamer and I explored how many NLP trainers actually used it for belief change, we found that hardly anyone did.[2]

Several years ago I came up with another format, a pattern based upon the psycho-logics of the difference between a mere "thought" and a semantically loaded "belief," a pattern that arose from the *Meta-States* model—the *Meta-No / Meta-Yes pattern.* With Bob Bodenhamer's assistance, we tested it and began using it in trainings and other contexts. In the years that have passed, it has proven a great way to change beliefs by using the dis-confirmation / confirmation process.[3]

Later Bob and I took on the "Sleight of Mouth" patterns. We wanted to see what would happen if we rigorously applied *Meta-States* to the reframing patterns. Out of that I reworked it into a *seven directions* model that Bob and I called *"Mind-Lines: Lines for Changing Minds."*[4] What are these seven directions? The seven directions describes the directions that we can "send a brain." Then, into those seven directions we fitted the numerous linguistic patterns. What resulted from this? This incredibly simplified the conversational reframing patterns and enabled learners to classify the patterns within the $7^{+/-2}$chunks of information making the model easier to remember and easier to use in actual conversation.

Working with Limiting Beliefs
Now, typically, in *reframing* we begin with a limiting or even sabotaging belief—an idea that interferes with excellence, that undermines accessing our full range of resources, and that creates a map of things that prevents us from living and experiencing as fully as possible. The limiting belief invites confusion, sabotage, self-doubt, worry, and fear. Within that idea is a frame, or multiple frames, that make it toxic or at least limiting.

In response, we use the Mind-Lines model to conversationally *re-frame* things. That is, we say words in such a way that it provides a rich and enticing map that opens up new vistas and opportunities. The conversational reframing may invite a new way of thinking by moving the person's focus in seven ways.

- It may invite a deframing of the old frame to loosen it up and give the person a chance to look afresh at things—*deframing.*
- It may provide a lateral shift that invites a new and different *perspective—reframing.*
- It may invite a look at things from the past and so frame things as having positive intentions or positive causes—*preframing.*
- It may zoom out into a future perspective and look back on things so as to invite a consequential framing of things—*postframing.*
- It may flip around and throw some aspect of the current frame back into the speaker's face to test its congruency and universality—*counter-framing.*
- It may soar upward to higher reaches of the mind and perspective and layer one or multiple frames upon the frame thereby changing the psycho-logics of the semantic

structure—*outframing.*

- It may do some side-stepping as it steps into the land of metaphor and analogy and covertly, implicitly, and non-directively frame from the side—*analogous framing.*

Working with Empowering Beliefs

If we can do this with limiting beliefs, what about empowering beliefs? The amazing thing is that the *Mind-Lines model* works just as well with beliefs that enhance and enrich life. We can use the same *Mind-Line* questions to intentionally use them to build up, extend, and expand an already powerful and wonderful belief.

When I first considered this, I really didn't think it would work. The very idea of it sounded too incredible. But then I thought, if it could work, it would be a marvelous idea. So I tried it. And what I found is that the same *Mind-Line questions* that can challenge and reformulate a limiting belief can empower an already enhancing belief.

How can that be? The reason is the attitude or intention or frame that we bring to our use of the *Mind-Line* questions. If we come with *the intention* to change a belief, then we set an implicit and covert and presuppositional frame of "Let's change this baby!" And if we come with *the intention* of consolidating and supporting a belief, then our presuppositional frame and "frames by implication" involve "Making this belief more robust than ever before." And the magical thing about beliefs, even covert, implicit ones is that they organize things so that they become self-fulfilling.

Consequently over the years in *Mind-Lines Trainings* we have repeatedly seen that the following set of *Mind-Lines Questions* can work as both a Neuro-Semantic Belief Change Pattern and as a Belief Enhancer pattern.

Mind-Lining as a Belief Change or Belief Enhancing Process

1) Identify a belief.

Do you want to identify a limiting and sabotaging belief that undermines your effectiveness? Or would you rather identify a positive and enhancing belief that if you believe even more fully, it would truly enrich your life and empower you?

2) Express the belief in a clear and succinct sentence.

Now as you think about some belief that truly serves you very well which you wouldn't mind enriching, extending, and making even more magical, express this belief in a congruent and expressive way that you find compelling.

Or, as you think about a belief that limits and even sabotages you, express that belief so that you can hear out loud what you think in the back of your mind.

Have you written the statement down so that you can record it?

3) Facilitate the process by asking Mind-Line question about the belief.

If you're the coach, use the following questions. As you do, use lots of *confirmation* and *affirmation* statements in the process to create a supportive atmosphere.

If you're the experiencer, then simply respond naturally and easily to the questions. As you do, fully experience the representations and feelings that the belief elicits, noticing them, witnessing them, and being with them.

While there is no *right* procedure for asking the questions, the following arrangement gives you one way to begin. AS you develop your artistry in this skill, you'll find that you will increasingly follow and pace the energy of the speaker. I have included the full list of Mind-Line questions at the end of this article.

The Mind-Line Questions—

What do you believe?
What do you mean by X or Y? (X being the external referent, Y the internal one.)
What do you mean by that?
How do you know that you believe this? And how do you know that?
So this means this X to you? (Confirmation with doubting tone for limiting belief, with celebrative tone for empowering belief.)
And does it mean anything else?
How does this benefit you? How does it enrich your life?
How does this serve in a positive way for you?
Did you create this map yourself or did you learn it from someone else?
When did you first learn to think this way?
What does this lead to?
And when you get those benefits, what does that tend to lead to?
When you think this way and use this belief to move through the world, how does it affect your identity or the way you define yourself?
Do you have to do it this way?
Is that all it means to you? Anything else?
How is that valuable to you?
Is it ecological? When you step back from it, is it productive, healthy, and useful?
What is it like?
And so on as you run through the 26 mind-lines.[4]

Summary

Changing beliefs are not difficult if you know their structure and have some effective tools. The *Mind-Lines model* simply provides yet another way to *change* a limiting belief and to update the mental maps that we use to navigate through life. This model also enables us to strengthen and consolidate a new empowering belief so that we commission it to operate as a command to our nervous system.

End Notes:

1: You can find the *Museum of Old Beliefs* pattern in *Changing Belief Systems with NLP* (1990), *Beliefs: Pathways to Health and Well-being* (1990), and also in *The Source Book of Magic* (1997).

2: See *Sub-Modalities Going Meta* (2005) updated from previous title, *The Structure of Excellence* (1999).

3: See *Secrets of Personal Mastery* (1999) and the website, www.neurosemantics.com for several articles and patterns on this.

4: The book *Mind-Lines: Lines for Changing Minds* (2005), now in its fifth edition, rigorously reformats and remodels the reframing patterns of NLP and Neuro-Semantics. There are 26 patterns of mind-lines within the seven directions.

Appendix D
The Blame Frame Game
that Gave Birth to

BANDLER'S MIND CHANGING LINES

In NLP we have numerous statements that function as paradigm changing mind-lines. Such powerful statements (like *the NLP Presuppositions*, Appendix A) succinctly and powerfully summarize a whole new way of thinking about things. They give us a new perceptual grid as they set new frames.

From the book *Using Your Brain—For a Change* (1985), you can see and hear a master like Richard Bandler playfully, challengingly, and seductively presenting the following mind-lines. Enjoy his artistry. . . for soon, you'll get to replicate this form of linguistic elegance.

On Learning—

"The problem with brains is that they learn things too quickly and too well. Human beings have an amazing ability to learn. . . the bad side . . . you can learn garbage just as easily as you can learn useful things." (p. 10)

"It's an amazing thing to be able to remember to get terrified every time you see a spider. You never find a phobic looking at a spider and saying, 'Oh damn, I forgot to be afraid." Are there a few things you'd like to learn that thoroughly? When you think about it that way, having a phobia is a tremendous learning achievement." (11)

"Phobics are people who can learn something utterly ridiculous very quickly. Most people tend to look at a phobia as a problem rather than an achievement. They never stop to think, 'If she can learn to do that, then she should be able to learn to do anything.'" (p. 46)

First efforts at learning: "When you do it the first time, you stumble around a bit. Later, when you're more familiar with what you're doing, you get more streamlined and systematic.' (86)

On Human Nature and Behavioral Problems

"People work perfectly. I may not like what they do, or they may not like it, but they are able to do it again and again, systematically. It's not that they're broken; they're just doing something different from what we, or they, want to have happen." (15)

*"*Another difficulty with most psychology is that it studies broken people to find out how to fix them. That's like studying all the cars in a junkyard to figure out how to make cars run better. If you study lots of schizophrenics, you may learn how to do schizophrenia really well, but you won't learn about the things they *can't* do." (15)

"I always keep in mind that anything anybody has done is an achievement, no matter how futile or painful it may be. *People aren't broken; they work perfectly!* They important question is, *'How do they work now?'* so that you can help them work perfectly in a way that is more pleasant and useful." (143)

On Getting Depressed

"There are times when you don't get what you want from someone else. But when you don't get what you want, *feeling bad is extra!* Did you ever think of that? First you don't get what you want, and then you have to feel bad for a long time because you didn't get it."

Man who claimed to have been depressed for 16 years. "That's amazing! You haven't slept in that long?" (*Counter-Example)* The structure of what he's saying is this: 'I've coded my experience such that I am living in the delusion that I have been in the same state of consciousness for 16 years.' I *know* he hasn't been depressed for 16 years. He's got to take time

out for lunch, and getting annoyed, and a few other things. People spend a lot of money and time learning to meditate in order to stay in the same state for an hour or two. (*Counter-example)* If he were depressed for an hour for an hour straight, he wouldn't even be able to notice it, because the feeling would habituate and thereby become imperceptible. . . ."
You can cure people of what they've got, and discover that they never had it. 'Sixteen years of depression' could be only 25 hours of actually being depressed." (*Deframing)* (pp. 28-29)

On Change

"Psychologists are always looking for the 'deep hidden inner meaning.' They had taken too many poetry and literature classes. Change is a lot easier than that, if you know what to do." (16)

On Confusion

"Confusion is always an indication that you';re on your way to understanding. Confusion presupposes that you have a lot of data, but it's not yet organized in a way that allows you to understand it." (p. 83)
"Years ago I realized I had been wrong so many times, I decided I'd just go ahead and be wrong in the ways that were more interesting." (85) [**ML:** apply "interesting" to "being wrong"]
"If you understood everything I said, and never got confused, that would be a sure sign that you were learning nothing of significance, and wasting the money you paid to come here.
The healthiest thing you can do . . . is to become confused, and (while) many people complain about how confusing I am, They don't yet realize that *confusion is the doorway to a new understanding.* Confusion is an opportunity to rearrange experience and organize it in a different way than you normally would. That allows you to learn to do something new and to see and hear the world in a new way." (p. 95)
"So whenever you get confused, you can get excited about the new understanding that awaits you. And you can be grateful for this opportunity to go somewhere new, even though you don't yet know where it will take you." (96)

On wanting everything to come easy

"What if you grew up and everything was wonderful all the time? You'd grow up to be a wimp, totally unable to cope. . ." (p. 52)

On Certainty — Uncertainty

"Certainty is where people stop thinking and stop noticing. Any time you feel absolutely certain of something, that's a sure sign that you have missed something." (97) [ML: Content Reframing]
"Certainty probably impedes human progress more than any other state of mind." (98)
"Whenever you think that you understand totally, that is the time to go inside and say, 'The joke is on me." Because it is in those moments of certainty that you can be sure that the futile learnings have set in, and the fertile ground has not been explored. Obviously, there is always a lot more left to learn, and that is the fun part of NLP, and its future." (156)
"There is *so* much more inside our minds that we suspect. There is *so* much more outside than we are able of being curious about. It's only that growing sense of curiosity that allows you to capture the enthusiasm that makes even the most mundane, or the most fascinating task worthwhile, fun, and intriguing. Without that, life is nothing more than waiting in line." (159)

On influence, control, and manipulation:

"Many therapists even have a rule against being effective. They think that influencing anyone directly is manipulative, and that manipulation is bad. It's as if they said, 'You're paying me to influence you. But I'm not going to do it because it's not the right thing to do.' When I saw clients, I always charged by the *change*, rather than by the hour; I only got paid when I got results." (p. 53)

"A lot of people think that NLP sounds like 'mind control' as if that were something bad. I said, 'Yes, of course.' If you don't begin to control and use your own brain, then you have to just leave it to chance." (118)

On Relationships

"The greatest error of all is in thinking that the only way for you to feel good in certain situations is for someone else to behave in a certain way. 'You must behave the way I want you to, so I can feel good, or I'm going to feel bad and stand around and make you feel bad too.'" (p. 62)

"One thing that has always amazed me is that people are seldom nasty to strangers. You really have to know and love someone before you can treat her like dirt and really make her feel bad about small things. Few people will yell at a stranger about important things like crumbs on the breakfast table, but if you love her, it's OK." (p. 64)

On Interrupting an Over-Controlling and Angry Dad

A father dragged his daughter into a counseling office with her arm twisted up behind her back and shoved her into a chair. . .

"Is there anything wrong?" I asked.

"The girls a little *whore."*

"I don't need a whore; what did you bring her here for?"

"No, no! That's not what I'm talking about. . ."

"Who is this girl?"

"My daughter?"

"You made your daughter into a *whore!!!"*

"No, no. You don't understand. . ."

"And you brought her here to *me!* How disgusting!"

[This man who came in snarling and yelling is now pleading with me to understand him. He has totally switched from attacking his daughter to defending himself. Meanwhile, his daughter has been quietly cracking up. She thought that was wonderful.]

"You brought her in here with her arm twisted up behind her back and threw her around. That's how prostitutes are treated; that's what you're training her to do."

"Well I want to force her to. . ."

"Oh, 'force' — teach her that men control women by throwing them around, ordering them around, twisting their arms behind their back, forcing them to do things against their will. That's what pimps do. Then the only thing left to do is to charge money for it." (pp. 64-65)

[ML: Apply to Self. Reframe Content.]

"Let me ask you. . . look at your daughter. Don't you want her to be able to feel love, and to enjoy sexual behavior? But how would you like it if the only way she learned to interact with men was the way you brought her in that door a few minutes ago? And she waited until she was 25 and married somebody who beat her up, threw her around, abused her, and forced her to do things against her will?

[ML: Apply Values to — Post-Frame: Outcome]

"But she may make a mistake, and it will hurt her."

"That's possible. Two years from now that guy may drop her like a hot rock and go away. And when she feels bad and lonely . . . she'll have no one to go to, because she'll hate your guts. "

[ML: Outcome of Outcome]

"Isn't it more important that she learn to have loving relationships? Or should she learn to have the morals of any man that can force her around? That's what pimps do." (66)

[ML: Prioritizing of Values]

WHEN BANDLER PLAYED THE PARANOID BLAME GAME

L. Michael Hall, Ph.D.

While working recently on updating *"the myth"* about the origin of the "Sleight of Mouth" patterns, I read Robert Dilts' description in his recent book, *Sleight of Mouth (1999).* Robert tells about how he put together the very first list of 14 "Sleight of Mouth" Patterns from an NLP training in Washington D.C. The year was 1980.

> "In order to make a teaching point during a seminar, Bandler, who is renowned for his command of language, established a humorous but 'paranoid' belief system, and challenged the group to persuade him to change it. Despite their best efforts, the group members were unable to make the slightest progress in influencing the impenetrable belief system Bandler had established. . ." (p. x)

Richard was working with a young man who was breaking up with a girlfriend and who thought he wanted to work on his "issues," but who then dug in his heels. Robert says that this young man

> "was quite creative at thwarting every option, possibility, or reason that Bandler brought up as to why he might reconsider his opinions about his girlfriend and their relationship." (p. 272)

So, with his "flare for the outrageous" Richard used an experience of a defective stage setup (the corner of the platform buckled two times so that he stumbled) to create "a ridiculous situation." This gave him the chance to accuse and blame "Vic" (who tried to fix the stage) of purposefully trying to hurt him. He presented this negative and toxic belief as a metaphor for Ben who refused to consider giving his girlfriend another chance.

In *Sleight of Mouth,* Robert has reproduced an extensive transcript from that 1980 training as well as his analysis of the transcript. This transcript reveals Richard's use of "Sleight of Mouth" patterns in maintaining and holding a "thought virus" (negative belief). This transcript actually provided Robert Dilts the basis for separating out his original 14 "Sleight of Mouth" patterns.

Yet in reading it again, I found that it also shows the dark side of *Frame Games. So,* in a similar way to Robert's fine analysis, I want to present yet another analysis using the same content. Here I want to present it as *NLP's First Frame Game*, or . . .

When Bandler Played the Paranoid Blame Game

The following *frame game* powerfully illustrates how a person can take a negative idea or belief and hold it, maintain it, support it, and refuse to let "helpers" fix it. I have only quoted part of the text of the transcript. The ellipses dots (. . .) indicate parts of the dialogue left out. I highly recommend examining Robert's full text in his book and his explanations as well.

In that sense, Richard is here also playing for the seminar group the *frame game* "Fix Me if You Can!" First, the negative belief full of state-dependency Mind-Reading of negative intentions as he plays the

Blame Game. This is an especially sick frame game and not one recommended. It does, however, show the persuasive power of language.

RB: The person that put this *(platform) back together, get out. Never again will I trust you. (To Ben) He had his chance, and didn't test it well enough. I'll never trust him again. See, he doesn't care about my future. . . . He doesn't care if I break my leg, does he? . . . How could he do that to me? (To Vic) Why do you want to hurt me? Huh?

[The *Blame Game* accuses and attacks the motives and intentions of another. To play this game, just engage in some *mind-reading* and ask the "why" question. This will put others on the defense.]

Vic: I don't.

RB: Well, then *why* did you do that to me? [Blame Game driven by "why."]

Vic: I set it up so that you would learn that that thing [the stage] is solid as a rock now.

RB: *But what if* it's not, *what if* I fall and break my leg?

[Game maintained by the use of "What if. . ." Vic *within* the game and engaging in a *Frame War*]

Vic: It's all right, it's solid as a rock. [Assurance, but within the frame.]

RB: So you want me to go out there and risk my life.

[This reflects *Frame Dependency* (similar to State Dependency). Frame Dependency sees and experiences things in terms of the frame. More Mind-Reading and accusation. The game continues.]

Vic: If I risk my life first, is that all right?

[Inviting RB to play *Let's Test Reality* frame game.]

RB: Do you know how many times I have to walk on that compared to you? I tested it the last time you know and it was fine and then I stepped on it and, boom, there I was. I fell all over again.

[Refusal to play the new game. The *Blame Game* now supported by another higher frame: "I Refuse to Put Things to the test."]

Vic: You stepped on the right part. It's a weird setup.

[Vic tries to explain, but because he speaks from *within* the frame of the Blame Game, it doesn't work.]

RB: Yeh, it is. I just don't understand. It doesn't make any sense to me. It blows my mind that anyone would do that to me. . .

[Uses confusion and lack of understanding to repeat the Blame Game.]

Man #1: As long as you avoid stages in the future, everything will be okay.

[Runs with the logic of the Limiting Belief and states consequence.]

RB: See he's trying to help me. I can't get anything out of him (Vic). All he's telling me is 'go do it again'. . . .

[Refuses and rejects the Consequence Mind-Line by using it as Positive Intention in the speaker in contrast to Bad Intentions in Vic and so the Blame Game continues.]

. . .

RB: Now I really know he's trying to hurt me. . . . This guy comes to my seminar and tries to kill me. And he's still trying."

[When Vic doesn't test the stage himself, that's more "proof" of his bad intentions.]

. . .

Man #2: *Why* do you think he thought he had to put the piece back there rather than move it away?

[Reasoning *within* the frame. But this "why?" only plays into the frame game.]
RB: I don't know why he did it. Maybe he doesn't like me. Maybe he wants to hurt me. Maybe he just doesn't think about what he'll do in the future that would hurt me. . .

[Asking "why" only allowed the Blame Frame to invent more supporting reasons and justifications!]

Woman #1: Yeh, *but if* he didn't think in the future what might happen, he probably didn't do it deliberately.

[The Frame War! "Yes, but. . ."]
RB: If he didn't think about my future, then he won't next time, and then he's going to get me in some situation where I'm really going to get burned.

[The problem with a direct, frontal attack on someone's Frame is that it initiates a Frame War . . . and if it operates *within the logic* of the Negative Frame, then it just evokes defensiveness and so solidifies that frame.]

Man #2: *But* you only have one example so you don't know that for certain.
RB: He did it twice! And I gave him a whole bunch of choices about how to do something to prove to me that he wasn't trying to hurt me. He said he would walk on it and 'risk his life' first. Did he do it? No. He didn't do it. . . . He doesn't care about me. He doesn't give a damn. . .

[And the Frame War continues. Push, shove, counter-push, etc. The call to "reasoning" by Man #2 only plays into the Blame frame game.]
Woman #1: *Why* don't you both turn the platform over and make sure it works right. Have him work with you to test it.

[Ah, another *why* question *within* the frame.]

RB: So you want me to try and get together to work with him . . . then I'm going to be the one who's going to stand on it for the next three or four days. You're on his side. I knew you were with him all along. . ."

[Re-instatement of the Blame Game, now directed toward the "helper."]
Woman #1: Then I'll do it with him. . . Oh, you don't trust because you think we (she and Vic) are allies.
RB: Oh yeh, trying to make me look paranoid now, huh? He (Vic) put you up to this didn't he?"

[The Frame War continues. The *kind of thinking* that created the problem frame of blame and accusation and suspicion cannot solve itself as a frame.]

Woman #2: What do you want at this point?

[Attempt to step outside of the frame.]
RB: I don't want anything. I didn't want it (the stage) back there in the first place. It's too late now.

[Refuses to step out. Refuses the new Outcome Frame. That would spoil the Blame Game.]

Woman #2: You're not willing to give him another chance?
RB: He had his chance. . . . (then repeating of the Blame Frame). . .

Man #1: I think you should leave because he might hide outside.

[Playing *within* the Blame Game Frame. . . exaggerating it, extending it.]
RB: Maybe I should hide.

[Plays it even further so it doesn't question the frame!]
. . .
RB: Why are you making excuses for him (Man #3). . . They're all on the front row, every one of them.

[The Blame Game has become the Paranoid Game, "They are all against me!"]
Woman #2: It's mass action. The mob is taking over.
[Attempting to exaggerate and play with the frame.]
RB: Oh. See, she's trying to make me look paranoid too.
[The Blame Frame about her exaggeration.]

Woman #2: *No,* I'm concerned about why you feel that all these people are against you.
[Ah, more Frame War.]
RB: Don't give me that. (To Vic) Now, see all the trouble you've caused. . . .
[Refusal to defend self, shift into more Blaming. This maintains that frame.]

Man #4: He's awfully clever to be doing it in such a round about way.
[A tease to play another game, exaggeration. . . trying to loosen the frame.]
RB: He's a smart person, man.
[Stays "serious," this maintains the Blame Frame.]
Man #4: Can we out smart him?
RB: I don't know. He got me once. He got me twice. God knows who else he's gotten.
[The Paranoid Frame Game is intensified by using the man's intelligence as part of the problem.]
. . .
Vic: I'll move it over here. (Begins to move the small platform away.)
RB: *Why* is he trying to make me look stupid? See, now he's trying to make it look like nothing happened. . . .
[Uses the "why" to support the Blame and Paranoid Frame.]
. . .
RB: . . . even if you'd bring in a new stage, I would only be safe for a while. Maybe he'll go cut the leg on the other side. What do I know?
[Future pacing the Problem Frame! Predicting a negative future based on Paranoid frame.]

Woman #3: How do you know that he set that up in advance?
[Asked from *within* the frame, and so will only make matters worse.]
RB: Well, I don't, but that's not the point. . . . Even if he didn't mean it, it did happen. He's the one that's making me feel this way now. You see, I'm terrified.
[Refuses the frame, "that's not the point," and re-establishes the Blame Frame.]

Woman #3: How is he making you feel that way?
[Challenges the cause-effect frame.]
RB: That's not the point. The point is that I feel this way. If he hadn't done those things, I wouldn't feel bad. Now I *have to* continue to feel this way. . .
[Refusing the new frame while using "The Emotional Frame" to re-establish the Blame game. Then solidifies it with the "I have No Choice but I Have to Feel this way" frame game]

Woman #4: Can you remember things you did with him that you enjoy?. . .
[Invitation to step out of the Blame Frame . . . to use the Good Memory Frame.]
RB: Yeh. Sure those things are there, *but* I can't have any of those in the future. . .
[Rejection and refusal of the outframe by a "Yes, but. . ." retort.]

Woman #3: Is this the way you want to be?
[Invitation to outframe with Desired Identity Frame.]
RB: I don't want to be like this. I want to be the way I was.

[Ah, shift to the Aim Frame, at least momentarily. Sneaky use of using a Past Self to establish the Future Self.]

Woman #3: How were you? Tell me.

[She continues to explore the Aim Frame— How were you?]

RB: I used to be confident and happy. I liked people, and trusted people. I'm not like that anymore. See, what he did to me? (To Vic). See what you're doing to me. . .

[A slick move to Past Self Image as the desired future Self-Image enables him to regret what he doesn't have anymore and to Blame Vic and others for robbing him! And the Blame Game continues.]

Woman #3: Do you mean you can't do anything else or you won't do anything else?

[Nice invitation to make a crucial distinction between *can't* and *won't.* An invitation to shift to "It's My Choice" frame game.]

RB: What difference does it make. I don't know what to do.

[A whinny way to Refuse a Frame Game, but effective.]

Man #4: What he wanted to do to you is put you in the state you're in now.

[Now place and exaggeration play to evoke polarity response. Invitation to shift frame games.]

RB: I know. He just wants to feel superior to me. There are a lot of leader killers. . .

[Refuses to polarizes, takes, accepts and gives it the most blaming, paranoid interpretation possible.]

Playing Frame Games

We all play "games." We think, feel, act, talk, and transact with each other and we do so in terms of various *frames of references*. These create our frame games. Some are sick and toxic. Problem frames, blame frames, fatalistic frames, Negative Intentions, and paranoid frames—these typically just lock us into various mental and emotional prisons. Others are powerful for running our own brain and managing our own states and destinies: the Aim frame, the Solution frame, the Resourceful frame, the As If frame, the Positive Intention frame, etc.

The frames we set, that we accept, and that we live within establish the games that we play. And every frame involves a meta-level understanding, belief, value, decision, etc. These meta-states establish the contexts and orientation that we then experience. And this means that when we play *frame games*—

- we engage in the persuasion arts
- we evoke various states and meta-states
- we establish sets of interactions that define the quality of our relationships
- and we use our neuro-linguistics to create the higher levels of mind and meaning that then govern our lives.

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Appendix E

A Format for Mind-Lining

Worksheets

1) Specifying the Magic (How do you know? Specifically, what do you mean by. . .?)

2) Getting the Magical Strategy (So how does this work? What comes first, then what, and then what?)

3) Reframe the EB (This external behavior doesn't mean X, it really means Y)

4) Reframe the IS (If you really want to know what reflects this internal state, just look at . . .)

5) Reflexively Apply To Self (How interesting that you X on yourself!)

6) Reflexively Apply to Listener (So this X-ing also applies to me?)

7) Counter-Exampling (I don't get it, if X is Y, then how does Z experience fit into this?)

8) Positive Prior Intentional (I can appreciate that what you really want to truly accomplish is. . .)

9) Positive Prior Causation (I can see that what you truly seek to create, cause, make. . . is . . .)

10) First Outcome (And what this will lead to is. . .)

11) Outcome of Outcome (And then what will grow out of that result will be. . ..)

12) Ultimate Outcome (Once of these days, when you get to the end of your journey in this life, and you look back. . .)

13) Model of the World Outframing (Where did you get this frame of reference?)

14) Value Outframing (Tell me what's even more important than X)

15) Allness Outframing (To everybody, all the time, there's never an exception?)

16) Necessity Framing (What would happen if you didn't have to X?)

17) Identity Outframing (And so you have identified with X . . . what does this 'make' you in terms of

your identity?)

18) Outframing With Other Abstractions (So you conclude that X means this Y, have you considered that you could also see it as Z?)

19) Ecology Outframing (How well does this serve you? Does it truly enhance your life?)

20) Metaphor or Story Outframing ("Once upon a time, I had a friend by the name of John, and he. . .")

21) Both/And Framing (Does it have to be either/or? Could it be a both and situation?)

22) Pseudo-Word Framing (What if this term was not even an actual or real term, but false?)

23) Negation Framing (Suppose this way of viewing things just disappeared, vanished, went away)

24) Possibility and As If Framing (What is the possibility of an empower perspective?)

25) Systemic and Probability Framing (What's the probability that will happen?)

26) Decision Framing (Is that what you have decided? What have you decided?)

L. Michael Hall, Ph.D.

L. Michael Hall is a visionary leader in the field of NLP and Neuro-Semantics, and a modeler of human excellence. Searching out areas of human excellence, he models the structure of that expertise and then turns that information into models, patterns, training manuals, and books. With his several businesses, Michael is also an entrepreneur and an international trainer.

His doctorate is in the Cognitive-Behavioral sciences from Union Institute University. For two decades he worked as a psychotherapist in Colorado. When he found NLP in 1986, he studied and then worked with Richard Bandler. Later when studying and modeling resilience, he developed the Meta-States Model (1994) that launched the field of Neuro-Semantics. He co-created the *International Society of Neuro-Semantics* (ISNS) with Dr. Bob Bodenhamer. Learning the structure of writing, he began writing and has written more than 40 books, many best sellers in the field of NLP.

Applying NLP to coaching, he created the Meta-Coach System, this was co-developed with Michelle Duval (2003-2007), he co-founded the Meta-Coach Foundation (2003), created the Self-Actualization Quadrants (2004) and launched the new Human Potential Movement (2005) which is now one of the Professional Tracks of Neuro-Semantics.

Contact Information:

P.O. Box 8
Clifton, Colorado 81520 USA
(1-970) 523-7877

Websites:

www.neurosemantics.com
www.meta-coaching.org
www.self-actualizing.org
www.meta-coachfoundation.org

Books by L. Michael Hall, Ph.D.

NLP and Neuro-Semantics:
1) *Meta-States: Mastering the Higher Levels of Mind* (1995/ 2012).
2) *Dragon Slaying: Dragons to Princes* (1996 / 2000).
3) *The Spirit of NLP: The Process, Meaning and Criteria for Mastering NLP* (1996).
4) *Languaging: The Linguistics of Psychotherapy* (1996, spiral).
5) *Becoming More Ferocious as a Presenter* (1996, spiral book).
6) *Patterns For Renewing the Mind* (with Bodenhamer, 1997 /2006).
7) *Time-Lining: Advance Time-Line Processes* (with Bodenhamer, 1997).
8) *NLP: Going Meta—Advance Modeling Using Meta-Levels* (1997/ 2001).
9) *Figuring Out People: Reading People Using Meta-Programs* (with Bodenhamer, 1997, 2005).
10) *SourceBook of Magic, Volume I* (with Barbara Belnap, 1997).

11) *Mind-Lines: Lines For Changing Minds* (with Bodenhamer, 1997/ 2005).
12) *Communication Magic* (2001). Originally, *The Secrets of Magic* (1998).
13) *Meta-State Magic: Meta-State Journal* (1997-1999).
14) *When Sub-Modalities Go Meta* (with Bodenhamer, 1999, 2005). Originally, *The Structure of Excellence.*
15) *Instant Relaxation* (with Lederer, 1999).
16) *User's Manual of the Brain: Volume I* (with Bodenhamer, 1999).
17) *The Structure of Personality:* Modeling Personality Using NLP and Neuro-Semantics (with Bodenhamer, Bolstad, and Harmblett, 2001).
18) *The Secrets of Personal Mastery* (2000).
19) *Winning the Inner Game* (2007), originally *Frame Games* (2000).
20) *Games Fit and Slim People Play* (2001).

21) *Games for Mastering Fear* (with Bodenhamer, 2001).
22) *Games Business Experts Play* (2001).
23) *The Matrix Model: Neuro-Semantics and the Construction of Meaning* (2003/2016).
24) *User's Manual of the Brain: Master Practitioner Course, Volume II* (2002).
25) *MovieMind*: *Directing Your Mental Cinemas* (2002).
26) *The Bateson Report* (2002, spiral.
27) *Make it So! Closing the Knowing-Doing Gap* (2002). (Out of Print)
28) *Source Book of Magic, Volume II, Neuro-Semantic Patterns* (2003).
29) *Propulsion Systems* (2003, spiral).
30) *Games Great Lovers Play* (2004).

31) *Coaching Conversation, Meta-Coaching, Volume II* (with Michelle Duval & Robert Dilts 2004, 2010).
32) *Coaching Change, Meta-Coaching, Volume I* (with Duval, 2004/ 2015).
33) *Unleashed: How to Unleash Potentials for Peak Performances* (2007 Vol. III).
34) *Self-Actualization Psychology* (2008, Volume IV).
35) *Achieving Peak Performance* (2009, Volume V).
36) *Unleashing Leadership: Self-Actualizing Leaders and Companies* (2009, Vol VI).
37) *The Crucible and the Fires of Change* (2010, Volume VII).
38) *Inside-Out Wealth* (2010).
39) *Benchmarking: The Art of Measuring the Unquantifiable* (2011, Volume VIII).
40) *Innovations in NLP: Volume I* (Edited with Shelle Rose Charvet; 2011).
41) *Neuro-Semantics: Actualizing Meaning and Performance* (2011)
42) *Systemic Coaching: Coaching the Whole Person with Meta-Coaching* (with Pascal Gambardella, Ph.D., 2012, Volume IX).
43) *Group and Team Coaching* (2013, Volume X).
44) *Executive Coaching: Facilitating Excellence in the C-Suite* (2014, Volume XI).
45) *Political Coaching: Unleashing Self-Actualizing Politicians.* (2015, Volume XII).
46) *Collaborative Leadership,* with Ian McDermott. (2016).
47) *The Field of NLP* with John Seymour and Richard Gray (unfinished).
48) *The Meta-Coaching System* (2015, Volume XIII)

49) *Get Real: Unleashing Authenticity* (2016, Volume XIV).
50) *Inside-Out Persuasion* (2017, Volume XV)
51) *Creative Solutions* (2017)
52) *Executive Thinking* (2018)

Volume Books
Books written in weekly installments to the Neuro-Semantic community (Neurons), to the Meta-Coaches egroup (Morpheus), to the Neuro-Semantic Trainers egroup. These are now PDF books on the Neuro-Semantic website.

Neurons began as the Meta-Reflections in 2008 and each year consists of another book. 1) 2008. 2) 2009. 3) 2010. 4) 2011. 5) 2012. 6) 2013. 7) 2014. 8) 2015. 9) 2016. 10) 2017.

Morpheus began as the Meta-Coach Reflections in 2009. 2) 2010. 3) 2011. 4) 2012. 5) 2013. 6) 2014. 7) 2015. 8) 2016. 9) 2017.

Framers is the Trainers' Reflections which began in 2010. 1) 2010. 2) 2011. 3) 2012. 4) 2013. 5) 2014. 6) 2015. 7) 2016. 8) 2017.

Other books:
1) *Emotions: Sometimes I Have Them/ Sometimes They have Me* (1985)
2) *Motivation: How to be a Positive Influence in a Negative World* (1987)
3) *Speak Up, Speak Clear, Speak Kind* (1987)
4) *Millennial Madness* (1992), now *Apocalypse Then, Not Now* (1996).
5) *Over My Dead Body* (1996).

Order Books from: **NSP: Neuro-Semantic Publications**
P.O. Box 8
Clifton, CO. 81520—0008 USA
(970) 523-7877

Neuro-Semantics as an Association

In 1996 Hall and Bodenhamer registered "Neuro-Semantics" and founded *The International Society of Neuro-Semantics* (ISNS) as a new approach to teaching, training, and using NLP. The objective was to take NLP, as a model and field, to a higher level in terms of professional ethics and quality. Today Neuro-Semantics is one of the leading disciplines and movements within NLP as it is pioneering many new developments and demonstrating a fresh creativity similar to what characterized NLP when it was new.

Dr. Hall is known as a prolific writer, having authored 50 books in the field of NLP, many of them best sellers through *Crown House Publishes* (Wales, UK) and many of them translated into numerous languages: German, Dutch, Italian, Spanish, Russian, Japanese, Chinese, Arabic, Norwegian, Portuguese, etc.

www.neurosemantics.com www.self-actualizing.org
www.meta-coaching.org www.metacoachingfoundation.org

The Meta-Coaching System

As a complete and comprehensive coaching system, the *Meta-Coaching System* began in 2001 when L. Michael Hall, Ph.D. modeled four expert coaches. He then applied the Neuro-Linguistic Programming (NLP) and Neuro-Semantic models to the burgeoning field of Coaching. As a systemic model, the Meta-Coaching System enables a professional Coach to answer the question: *How do you know what to do, when to do it, with whom to do it, how to do what you're doing, and why?*

When you can think strategically as a Coach, you will be able to recognize where you are with a client and what to do. Having a theoretical model that answers the *why are you doing that?* question saves your coaching from being a grab-bag of tricks so you don't have to coach-by-the-seat-of-your-pants.

To met this rigorous criteria, the Meta-Coaching System is based on eight models—models which are based in Cognitive-Behavioral, Developmental, and Self-Actualization psychologies. The design is to give Meta-Coaching a credible scientific basis. Then as a coach you will not fall back on what you "feel like" on a certain day, your "intuitions" (which may be your own unresolved issues), or some trick that you have picked up on a weekend training.

Today Meta-Coaching standards are the highest in the field of Coaching as it offers specific behavioral benchmarks for every one of the 50 coaching skills. It also has developed a Benchmarking Intangibles Model for how to generate rigorous benchmarks for any value or skill. The Meta-Coaching System also has an accountability structure to the ethics and standards which governs every licenced Meta-Coach. There are now 14 books detailing the curriculum of Meta-Coaching, and several more in the works. The Meta-Coaching System is inclusive of other systems as Meta-Coaches around the world in 60 countries are often on the board of ICF and many other Coach training programs. Trainings in Meta-Coaching occur every year dozens of times in every continent.